

Investigating Trial Line Burden and Prosecutorial Efficiency in the DeKalb County District

Attorney's Office

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Introduction

In the following paper, our team presents a series of analyses conducted for the DeKalb County District Attorney's Office and offers recommendations for the office. The District Attorney's (DA) Office prosecutes felony cases committed in DeKalb County in Superior Court, handling thousands of cases per year. Our analysis focuses specifically on the Trial Division, which is responsible for prosecuting the majority of felony criminal cases in DeKalb County. In light of the high proportion of cases it prosecutes, evaluating the Trial Line's burden is critical to ensuring it is able to conduct its work effectively.

Ideally, the prosecutorial system should resolve cases efficiently and equitably to ensure that all cases receive appropriate attention and are handled in a timely manner. The DA's office uses Prosecutorial Performance Indicators (PPIs) to measure their ability to do so. For this paper, we are examining three key indicators: *Organizational and Staff Capacity*, which investigates whether cases are distributed evenly across attorneys and divisions; *Addressing Serious Crime*, which examines whether defendants charged with violent offenses are convicted at comparable rates across divisions; and *Timeliness and Case Processing*, which looks into whether cases are resolved efficiently (Home).

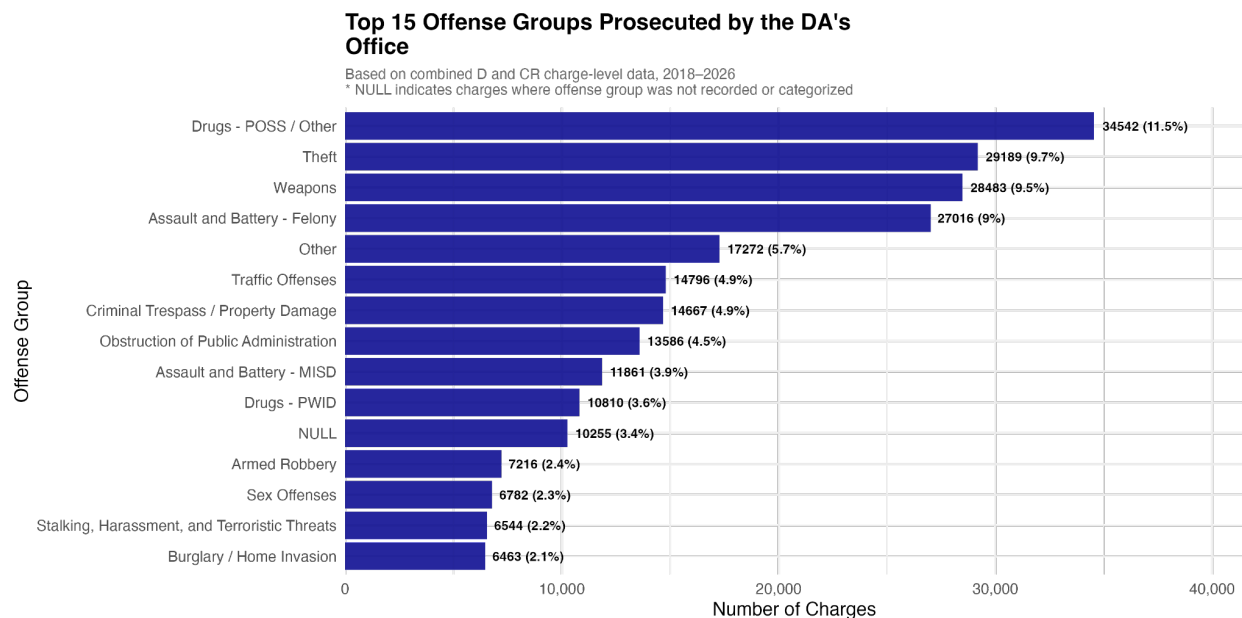
Background

Before sharing our findings, we need to situate them within the broader context of the District Attorney's Office and their work. From 2018 to 2025, the DA's Office received an average of 4717 cases per year. For the purposes of this paper, a case refers to a single criminal matter filed against one or more defendants arising from the same incident. While cases can

typically have just one defendant, it is possible for multiple defendants to be within one case if multiple defendants were involved in the case. For the DA's Office, we found that 88.7 percent of cases have only one defendant, while 8.4 percent have two defendants, and less than three percent of cases have three or more defendants. In the following paper, we will conduct many of our analyses at the case-defendant level, which is the unique pairing of a case and an individual defendant.

The DA's office also deals with a wide range of offenses, as seen below in Figure 1, predominantly handling charges related to possession of drugs, theft, and weapons.

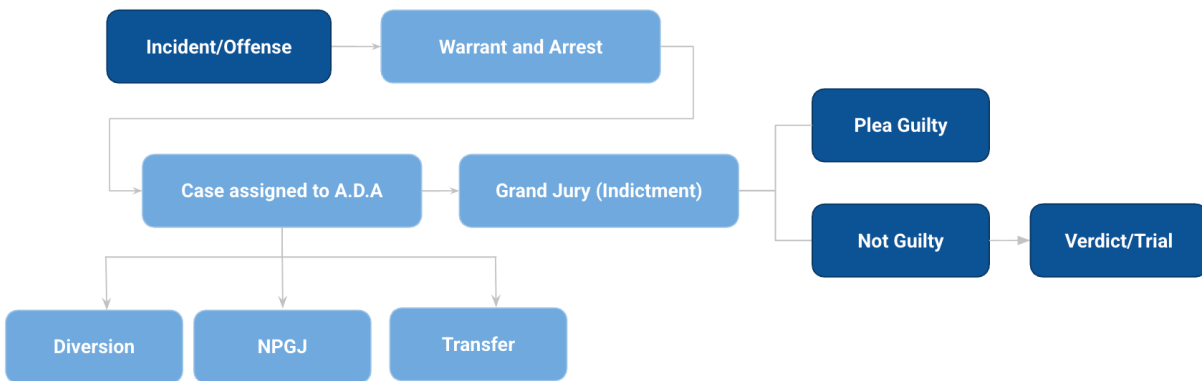
Figure 1. Top Offense Groups Prosecuted by DA's Office



To further contextualize our findings, it is important to also understand the path of a typical case through the criminal justice system. When an incident occurs, a warrant is issued, and an arrest is conducted for the individual(s) presumed to be involved with the crime. Following this arrest, the case is then assigned to an Assistant District Attorney, who may gather enough evidence to present it to a Grand Jury to Indictment. If the case is not indicted, it is either

Not Presented to Grand Jury (NPGJ'd), sent to diversion, or transferred to another Court. Should the case be indicted, however, the defendant can either plead guilty or not guilty. In the event that the defendant pleads not guilty, they will be sent to trial and receive a verdict.

Figure 2. Tracking A Case through DA's Office (Simplified)



Description of the Problem

Typically, the DA's office is divided into sixteen units. Most units specialize in prosecuting a certain type of crime, like the Anti-Corruption Unit (ACU) or Firearm Violence Prevention Unit (FVPU). These special units we use in our analysis are: the Anti-Corruption Unit (ACU), Child Crimes Unit (CCU), Crimes Against Elder Persons and Adults with Disabilities Unit (CAEPAD), Domestic Violence and Sexual Assault Unit (DVSA), Firearm Violence Prevention Unit (FVPU), Homicide and Gangs Unit (HGU), High Intensity Drug Trafficking Areas (HIDTA), Human Trafficking and Internet Crimes Unit (HTIC), and SB 440 Unit. The Trial Line, by contrast to these Special Units, handles those cases not assigned to Special Units, including the majority of felonies in the DA's Office, ranging from theft by shoplifting to armed robbery and murder.

The Trial Line itself consists of twenty attorneys, split between 10 divisions, one for each Superior Court judge. In this paper, we will explore whether the Trial Line is overburdened and further evaluate how efforts to increase efficiency in this system have performed. Within our paper, we hope to guide unit-level supervision and lay the groundwork for data-driven policy recommendations and informed staffing decisions.

The following analyses will use data from the DeKalb County District Attorney's Office, including, but not limited to, information on cases pre- and post-indictment, all cases charged, pending cases, and closed cases.

We must first caveat, however, that we cannot do any causal inference with this data. Moreover, several changes occurred in the period examined here including COVID-19 and changes in attorneys. We have done our best to account for these discrepancies, but we do note that it is impossible to remove the impact of COVID-19 on the criminal justice system in our analysis.

In the following paper, we will examine this key question about the Trial Line by looking at the distribution of incoming and outgoing cases from Trial Line compared to the Special Units and by analyzing case distribution and assignment to determine the equitable distribution cases and assignments. We will further look into which cases expired due to the Statute of Limitations on charges expiring and if transfers of cases from State Court Transfers are being done equitably so the DA's Office has enough time to indict them. Finally, we will examine the effectiveness of the Pre-Charging Unit, look into the pending felony caseload of the Trial Division and see if that caseload can be reassigned to Special Units, and examine the difference in Trial Division case outcomes, especially relative to Special Units.

I. Incoming and Outgoing Cases

Our first analysis aims to answer the question: is the Trial Line overburdened as compared to the Specialty Units? Further, what are the differences we can find in case outcomes between the Trial Line and Specialty Units?

To do so, we compared the overall flow of cases through the Trial Division and Specialty Units. The number of cases directly aligns with the amount of incoming work for the DA's office, as they are responsible for handling the cases. However, incoming cases are dependent on many factors outside of the DA's office such as police arrest timelines, whereas the number of outgoing cases represents the cases that the DA's office has resolved.

When the number of incoming cases exceeds the number of outgoing cases, then the number of cases begin to stack up, and the overall DA's office caseload increases. Why does this matter? That makes the whole process slower. Alternatively, when there are more outgoing cases than incoming cases—more cases are leaving than entering—the case backlog is being resolved. In the rare situation where outgoing cases equals incoming cases, the overall number of cases is going to stay the same. If there was no backlog, an equal incoming and outgoing rate would be ideal.

Investigating how the overall number of cases changes over time can help us understand how the DA's office and specific divisions' workloads are changing. Thus, we will analyze the relationship between incoming and outgoing relationships to see how the DA's office is handling this caseload over time.

Specifically, we will compare the Trial Division to Special Units. After indictment, some of the more complex and specific cases are assigned to Special Units. The Trial Division receives

and processes all of the cases that are not given to a specialized unit, from burglary to reckless driving. Cases are grouped by all of the charges for a single defendant (case-defendant level). All of the defendants for a single incident are put together and randomly assigned to a judge and attorney.

Results

Figure 3. Case-Defendant Level Incoming vs Outgoing Cases Over Time by Unit Type

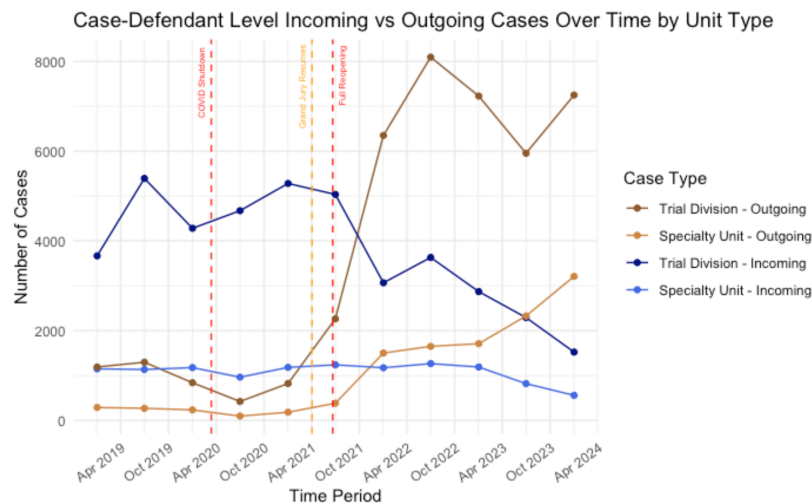


Figure 3 shows a graph with four different lines showing the counts of incoming and outgoing cases. The number of cases are displayed vertically, time horizontally, and three dotted lines to represent the COVID Shutdown. The Trial Division and Special Unit and incoming case lines follow a generally decreasing pattern. However, the Special Unit outgoing count consistently slowly increases. On the other hand, the Trial Division outgoing count stays slightly more consistent with a low count until post-shutdown where it suddenly spiked in mid 2022 with a high rate afterwards.

This only counts each defendant's case once. Each cases' "incoming" information comes from the received date and the "outgoing" information comes from the event date. It does not include information about defendants persecuted by HIDTA and SB440 since they serve very specific categories of cases that are not applicable to the more general specialized units.

Takeaways

Units' Annual Totals of Incoming and Outgoing Cases shows that the overall number of outgoing cases is increasing which seems to indicate that the COVID backlog is being addressed. Specifically, the Units' Annual Totals of Incoming and Outgoing Cases by Unit Type visualization shows that the Trial Division has been consistently addressing the COVID backlog at a higher rate than the Special Units.

To test if there was a statistically significant difference between the number of outgoing cases for Special Units and the Trial Division, three different Welch Two Sample t-tests were run. The data was split into three month periods and tested for a difference in each of the time periods: pre-COVID (until 3/13/2020), COVID (3/13/2020 to 6/21/2021), and post-COVID (6/21/2021 to the present). This yielded a set of three different p-values. Pre-COVID had a p-value of 0.001408, meaning that the difference between caseloads was significant. During COVID had a p-value of 0.09416, which is statistically insignificant, although this lack of statistical significance is likely due to the limited number of data points for this period. Finally, post-COVID had a p-value of 1.819e-07, which shows statistical significance.

Thus, we can conclude there is a significant difference in the count of outgoing cases between Trial Division and Special Units before and after COVID.

II. Case Distribution and Assignment

Our next section focuses on organizational and staff capacity, seeking to answer the question: are there significant differences in the distribution of cases, both over time, and across different divisions in the Trial Line? In addition, we examined the number of cases received and processed by the Trial Division compared to special units. This analysis seeks to help us understand how cases are distributed both across divisions within the Trial Line and also across the DA's Office, from 2018 to 2025. Also, the analysis helps us examine the caseload burden in different units at the Office.

Cases received by the DA's Office are assigned to a Division or unit quasi-randomly, in an order from Division 1 to 10. Then, based on the even or oddness of CR number's last digit of each case, it would be distributed to one of the two Trial Line attorneys at each Division.

Here, we classified all cases handled by the FVPU and HGU as major crimes because these cases result in severe threat to public safety and order of society. DVSA, CCU, CAEPAD, and HTIC are defined as Special Victim Unit (SVU) crimes.

Results

We visualized the number of cases assigned to each unit over time from January 2018 to March 2025. The shaded area indicates the office shutdown over COVID-19. Figure 5 shows the average number of cases assigned to each attorney every quarter. Over time, the average number of cases assigned to attorneys, regardless of division and units, remained relatively stable. Before the shutdown in 2019 Q4, an average of 47 cases were assigned to each attorney. Following the office reopening, a slight increase was observed in the average caseload assigned to each

attorney. With the slightly upward trend, we expect the workload to increase or remain stable at around 45 cases per attorney onwards.

Figure 4. CR cases assigned per attorney, Jan 2018 to Mar 2025.

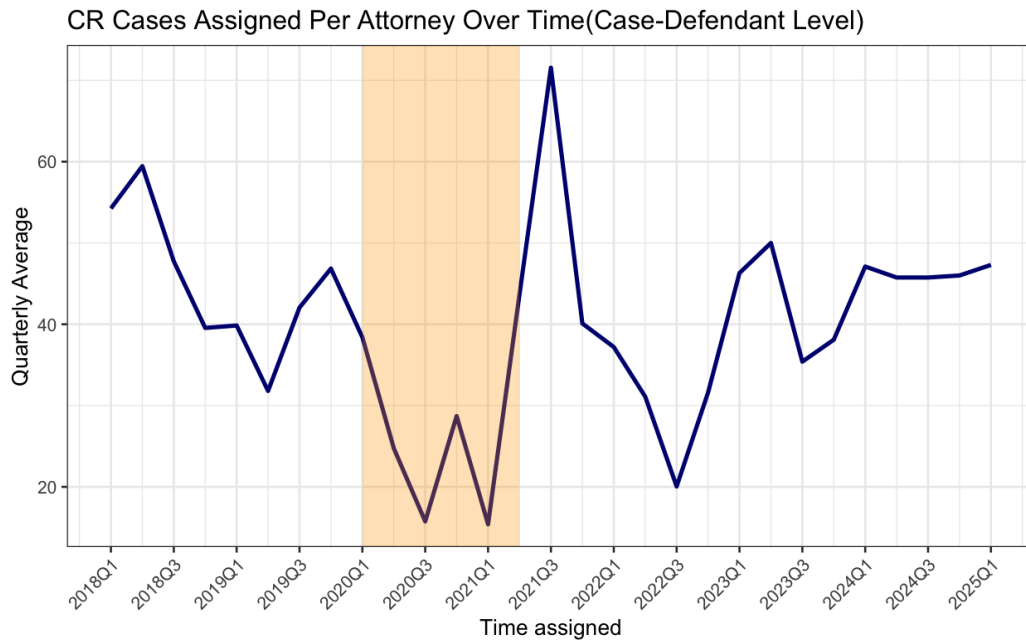
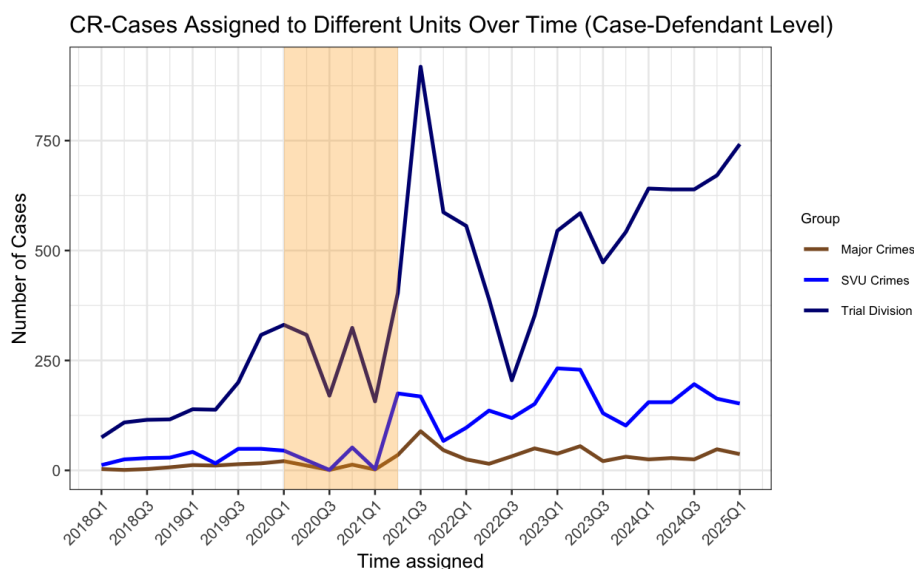


Figure 6 presents the changes in the number of cases over time, based on the time when these cases are assigned an attorney. The shaded area in orange represents the office shutdown during COVID-19. Overall, the number of cases processed and assigned followed a similar trend of changes across different units.

Figure 5. CR cases assigned to different units over time, Jan 2018 to Mar 2025.



A sharp increase was observed for all four categories when the office reopened after shutdown, followed by a drastic decrease in the next quarter, indicating that the COVID-19 backlog has been resolved. Following the reopening after COVID-19, the number of cases assigned per attorney has shown a slight upward trend. Over time, numbers of cases processed by special units and the trial line have both increased, although the Trial Line still takes over the majority of cases.

To conclude, the comparison of caseload between different units over time, both the time when cases are received (Appendix) and when they are assigned to an attorney, reflects the heavier burden of workload for the Trial Division.

III. Statute of Limitations

The following analyses concern the DA's office's efficiency with respect to the Statute of Limitations (SOL). For context, the Statute of Limitations is a statutory deadline placed on

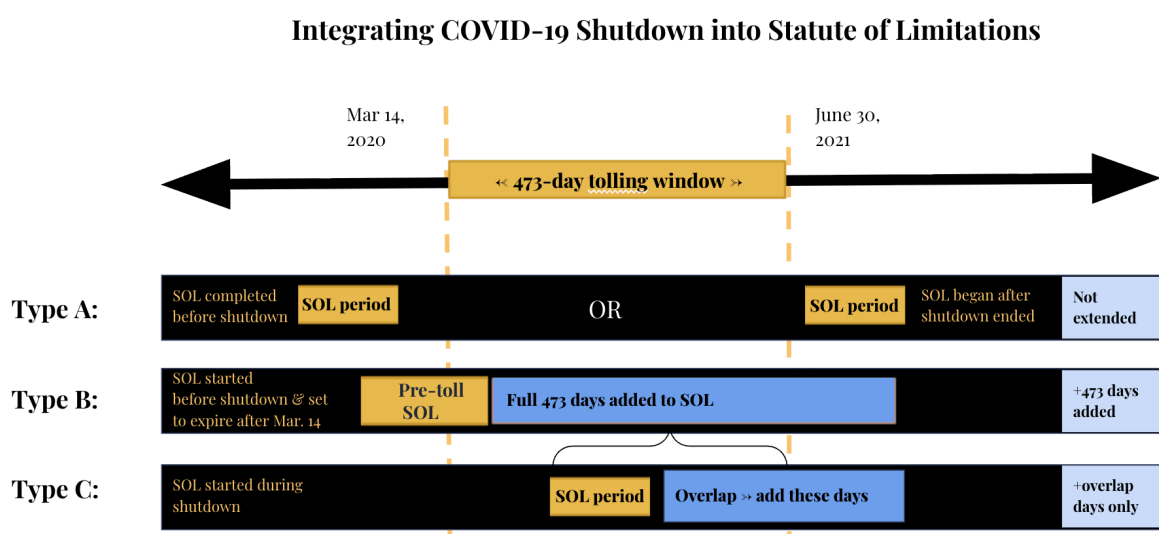
certain charges that prosecutors must indict said charge by. If the SOL “expires” or that clock runs out, the charge must be dismissed aka Not Presented to Grand Jury (NPGJ). The Statute of Limitations differs for different offenses and, for some serious charges, it does not exist at all. For example, misdemeanors typically have a two-year SOL, while charges like murder have no SOL at all. In this analysis, we look into two key considerations: 1) how many cases were indicted/accused just prior to the expiration of the Statute of Limitations?, and 2) how many cases were dismissed after the expiration of the Statute of Limitations?

It’s important to examine the Statute of Limitations, because a SOL that has expired is not beneficial from a prosecutor’s perspective, as this dismissal can be a sign of inefficiency. The SOL ensures that there is legal finality for those prosecuted by crimes, so defendants are safe from the threat of prosecution indefinitely. From the DA’s perspective, having many charges dismissed due to the expiration of the Statute of Limitations can represent prosecutorial inefficiency with respect to the timeliness of case processing, and thus mark a failure of a key PPI. Once a SOL expires, a charge cannot be prosecuted, which can imply inefficiency in the sense of resource constraints or investigative delays. This also causes issues with the prosecutorial system’s goal of bringing justice. If some of the defendants were, in fact, guilty, but they could not be brought to justice because the Statute of Limitations of their charges expired and therefore cannot be prosecuted, that is indicative of the prosecutorial system not working as it should.

Before examining the District Attorney’s Office’s efficiency with respect to the Statute of Limitations, it is important to understand that in the midst of the time period allotted for this case, the global pandemic impacted the DA’s Office’s processing of cases. As a result, as seen in Type B charges in Figure 6, the SOL was tolled, or paused, between March 14, 2020 and June

30, 2021, a span of 473 days, to give prosecutors additional time to indict charges. For charges with an SOL set to expire during or after the shutdown, the full 473 days were added to their expiration date. Further, for charges that came in during the shutdown, those seen as Type C, the SOL was only paused for the remaining days between the offense date and June 30, 2021. For charges that meet neither of these criteria—Type A charges where the SOL was completed before the shutdown or began after the shutdown—their SOL stayed the same. All of the following analyses are conducted with such tolling in mind.

Figure 6. Integration of COVID-19 Shutdown into the Statute of Limitations

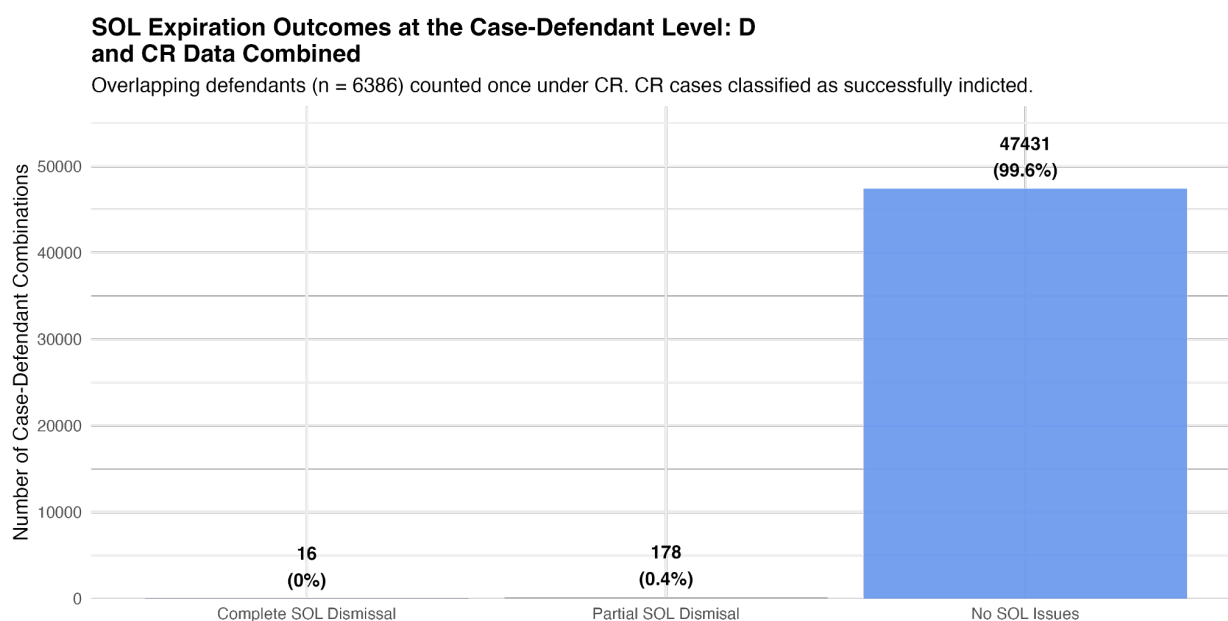


Main Results

Before entering into further analyses, we must contextualize all of this work within the broader District Attorney's Office's casework. Are many cases having charges dismissed due to the expiration of the Statute of Limitations? How common is it for a charge to expire in this manner?

Looking at it from a big picture perspective, we find that most cases in the DeKalb County District Attorney's Office, in fact, do not have any charges dismissed after the SOL was set to expire.

Figure 7: SOL Expiration Outcomes at the Case Defendant Level for Case (D) Data



Of all cases in the Case (D) Dataset—those that have not been indicted by the DA's Office—the vast majority of them (99.3 percent) have no SOL issues. Moreover, when we combine this analysis with the Case (CR) data, as seen in Figure 7, we find that this number is in fact higher, and 99.6 percent of the all case-defendants have cases involving No SOL Issues. This analysis contextualizes the DA's work as, in fact, being highly efficient with respect to the Statute of Limitations.

Zooming in closer, we must look into how close the DA's Office ends up dismissing cases prior to the expiration of the Statute of Limitations to understand its efficiency in regard to this issue.

Figure 8. NPGJ Cases: Proximity to SOL Expiration (Case-Defendant Level)

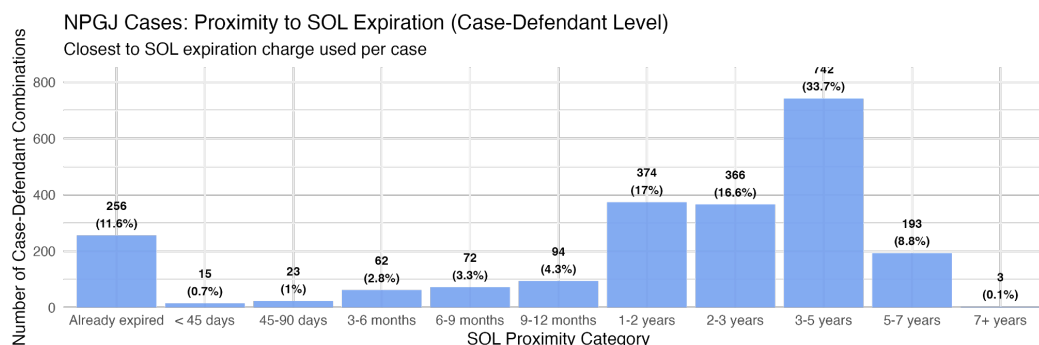
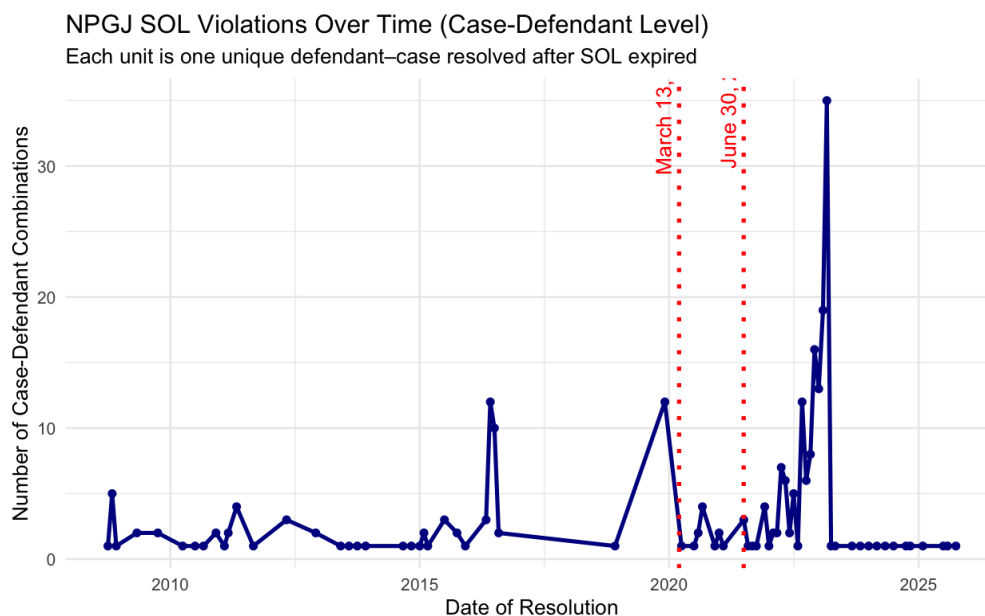


Figure 8 looks at all cases that included a charge that was dismissed (Not Presented to Grand Jury) to see if that case was dismissed just prior to the expiration of the Statute of Limitations for a charge. Here, the DA's office's efficiency is clear: only 38 cases included charges that were dismissed within 3 months of the SOL expiring. More likely than not, cases were dismissed much before the SOL of any charge was set to expire. Further, only 256 cases had charges dismissed due to the expiration of the Statute of Limitations.

We must then question that when the SOL does expire, however, when during the DA's Office's existence did these expirations typically occur? Here, we are looking at all SOL violations that were dismissed in the Case (D) Dataset.

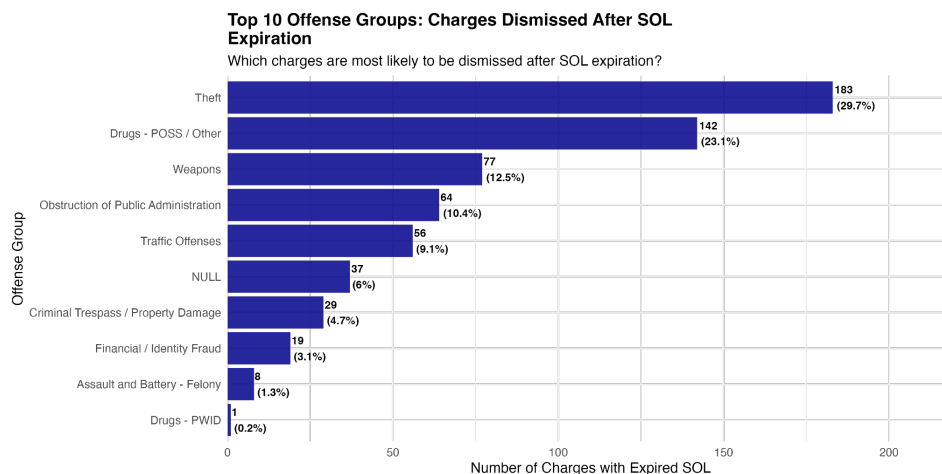
Figure 9: SOL Violations Over Time at the Case-Defendant Level



Looking at the graph of cases that include charges dismissed after SOL expirations over time, we can see a large spike post-COVID, likely due to the DA's Office dealing with the backlog of cases post-COVID. However, following September 2023, there were near zero SOL violations in any cases, showcasing a return to prosecutorial efficiency.

To understand what causes a case to be dismissed, we must also contextualize our work by seeking to understand what types of charges are typically dismissed to the expirations of the Statute of Limitations. Is the DA's Office dismissing a certain type of charge most often?

Figure 10: Top 10 Offense Groups: Charges Dismissed After SOL Expiration



Here, in figure 10, we can clearly see that the offenses most typically dismissed are (in order of percentage): Theft, Drug Possession, Weapons, Obstruction of Public Administration, and Traffic Offenses. More violent charges like Assault and Battery (Felony) tend to be dismissed after SOL has expired much less often.

Takeaways

Before sharing the key takeaways from this research it is important to add two key caveats. First, the interruption of the pandemic and its effect on the criminal justice system severely impacted this analysis. What seems like prosecutorial inefficiency might be less of a systemic error and more of an abnormal response to an external shock. During this time, the DA's office might be significantly more likely to dismiss charges to help deal with the backlog of cases received. On the other hand, due to the extensions on the SOL for COVID tolling, any decreases in SOL expirations during the COVID-19 period can be seen as resulting from this tolling, as opposed to an increase in efficiency. We must keep this key caveat in mind, especially when considering the dismissals of charges over time.

Secondly, we must caveat that there is no way to tell if a charge or case is dismissed due to the expiration of the SOL, limiting any causal inference in this analysis. While a charge might be dismissed after the SOL expires, we cannot speculate beyond that dismissal as to its reasoning and can only infer that it is due to the SOL expiring.

The most prominent takeaway here is that the DA's office is, in reality, very efficient with respect to SOL with only 781 expired charges due to SOL in the past 20 or so years, and 256 cases affected. Moreover, it does not dismiss many charges immediately prior to the SOL's expiration, lending credence to its efficiency with respect to the SOL. While there was a spike in charges dismissed after the SOL on them expired post COVID-19 tolling, this is likely due to a backlog that has since levelled out. Finally, we found that these charges are mainly non-violent, low-level felonies, such as theft, drug possessions, weapons, obstruction of public administration, or traffic offenses.

IV. State Court Transfers

This section examines the processing and handling of State Court Transfer (SCTR) cases within the District Attorney's Office. In particular, the analysis centers on how long these cases take to move through the system. This includes examining how much time remains on the statute of limitations (SOL) at the point of transfer and how cases are distributed across different units within the office. Together, this section helps provide a more complete picture of how SCTR cases move through the system and where potential pressures or areas of improvement may arise.

State Court cases originate in the State Court/Solicitor General's office, mostly as misdemeanors, and may later be escalated due to new evidence emerging, the severity of the offense increasing, or other factors that require felony-level prosecution. Then, they are

transferred to the Superior Court for felony-level prosecution. Because of this process, SCTR cases represent a different entry point into the DA's Office and often arrive later in their life cycle than standard Superior Court cases.

This distinction matters when interpreting timelines. Measures that begin at the offense date may appear longer for SCTR cases simply because part of the process occurred in State Court before transfer. In contrast, timelines beginning at the received date reflect processing within the DA's Office itself. As a result, SCTR cases provide a way to separate where time is spent in the overall process. Distinguishing between time before the DA becomes involved and time within the DA's Office allows for a more accurate understanding of system-level efficiency and avoids misleading conclusions about where delays are happening.

The significance of this section also ties closely to the Statute of Limitations (SOL). Because SCTR cases may arrive later in their lifecycle, they may have less time remaining before the SOL expires. This creates additional pressure on the DA's Office, as cases that are closer to expiration may require quicker prioritization and more immediate attention. In practice, this could affect how resources are allocated, how cases are prioritized, and how efficiently prosecutors are able to manage their workload. If a larger share of cases are entering with limited time remaining, it may not only impact individual case outcomes but also the overall functioning of the office.

Not every case that is transferred from State Court is ultimately accepted by the DA. As noted in the project data, a portion of transferred cases (about 13.6%) are not accepted and remain in State Court without receiving a D or CR number. Because those cases never fully enter the DA's system, this analysis focuses only on accepted SCTR cases, since those are the ones that contribute to DA workload and processing timelines.

As briefly mentioned above, one of the key reasons SCTR cases are different from standard DA cases is that they enter the system later in the case lifecycle. As a result, when looking at overall processing time, it is important to separate different stages of the case (such as offense to received, and received to disposition) to better understand and differentiate between time spent in State Court versus time spent within the DA's Office.

A major procedural change in how these cases move through the system between the two courts occurred with the implementation of the State Court Transfer Policy on October 14, 2020. Before this policy, the DA's Office often "took" cases directly from State Court before the formal transfer process was completed. In these situations, the DA was effectively involved earlier in the case, and the formal transfer documentation would follow afterward. After the policy was implemented, the process became more structured: State Court would first formally transfer the case, and then the DA's Office would review the transfer and decide whether to accept it. This created a clearer sequence in which transfer happens before intake, rather than after.

This policy change leads to two distinct case pathways that are used throughout the analysis. Before the policy, cases more often followed a "taken" pathway, where the DA received the case before formal transfer. After the policy, cases more often followed a "transferred" pathway, where transfer occurred before DA intake. However, in the analysis, pre- and post-policy groups are defined by timing relative to the policy date, not strictly by pathway. This distinction is important because it changes when the DA becomes involved in the case and therefore affects how much of the case timeline occurs before versus after DA involvement.

Results

Figure 11. Total count of State Court case-defendants by Case Pathway

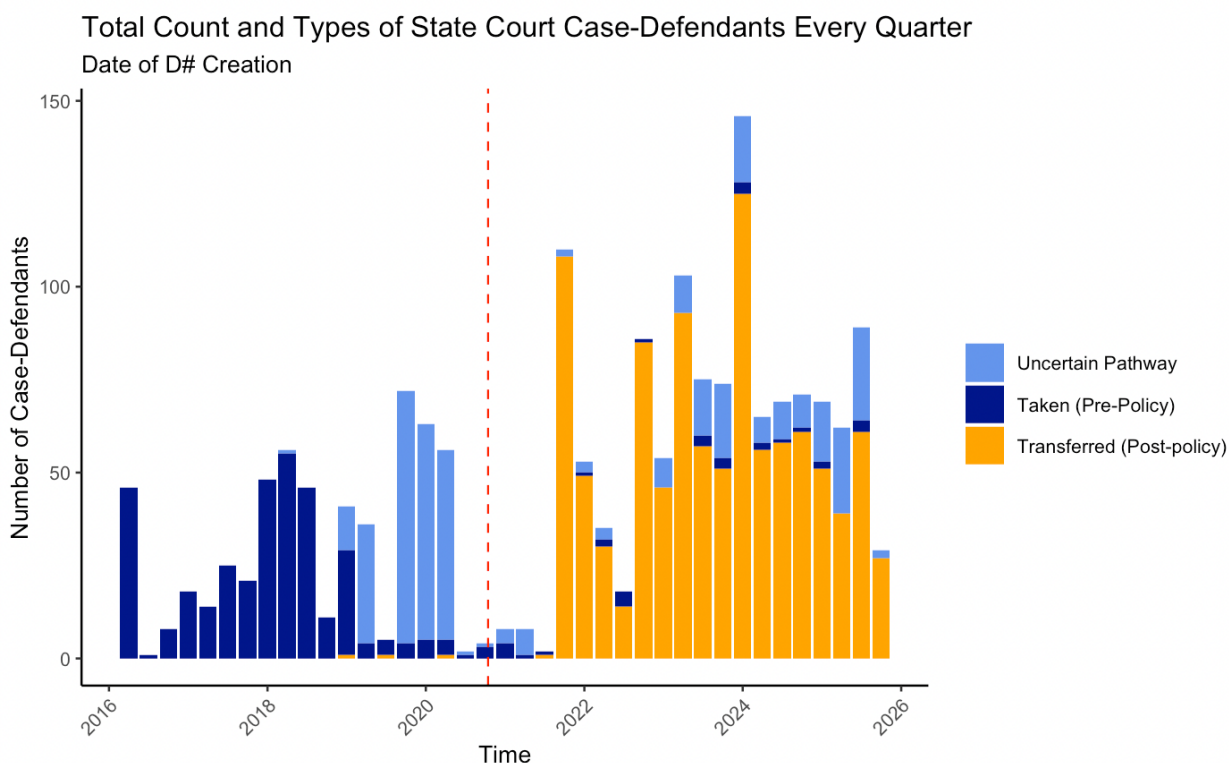


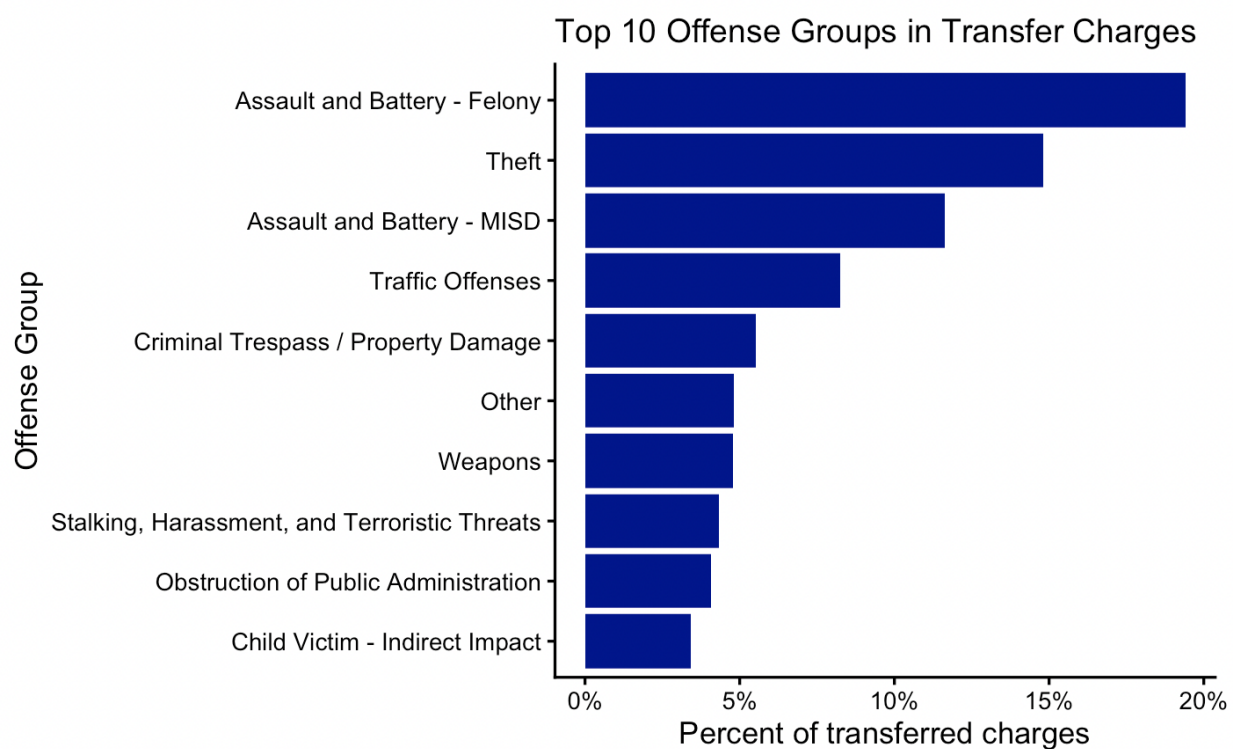
Figure 11 shows the number of State Court Transfer (SCTR) case-defendants entering the District Attorney’s Office over time, using the received date (D# creation date) as the reference point. The red dashed line marks the implementation of the State Court Transfer Policy. Overall, the graph shows an increase in the number of SCTR case-defendants over time, with a noticeable dip during the COVID-19 period when the court was on shutdown.

The graph distinguishes between taken (pre-policy) and transferred (post-policy) cases, along with a smaller group of same-day cases (labeled as “uncertain pathway”) where the transfer and received dates occur simultaneously. Because these same-day cases do not clearly follow either pathway, they are labeled as “uncertain pathway” in the pathway graph. In pre/post comparisons, however, they are included and assigned based on whether the shared date occurred before or after the policy implementation date.

This also visually reflects the shift in pathways around the policy date, showing that the distinction between taken and transferred cases represents a real structural change in how cases enter the system, rather than just a classification choice.

While the previous figure focuses on how cases enter the DA's Office over time, it does not show what types of cases are being transferred. Understanding the composition of these cases is important especially since State Court typically handles lower-severity offenses. Examining offense groups helps provide context for both the transfer process and unit distribution observed later in the analysis.

Figure 12. Case types (offense groups) most likely to be transferred



This visualization demonstrates the top 10 offense groups among charges that are transferred from State Court to the District Attorney's Office. The y-axis indicates the share each

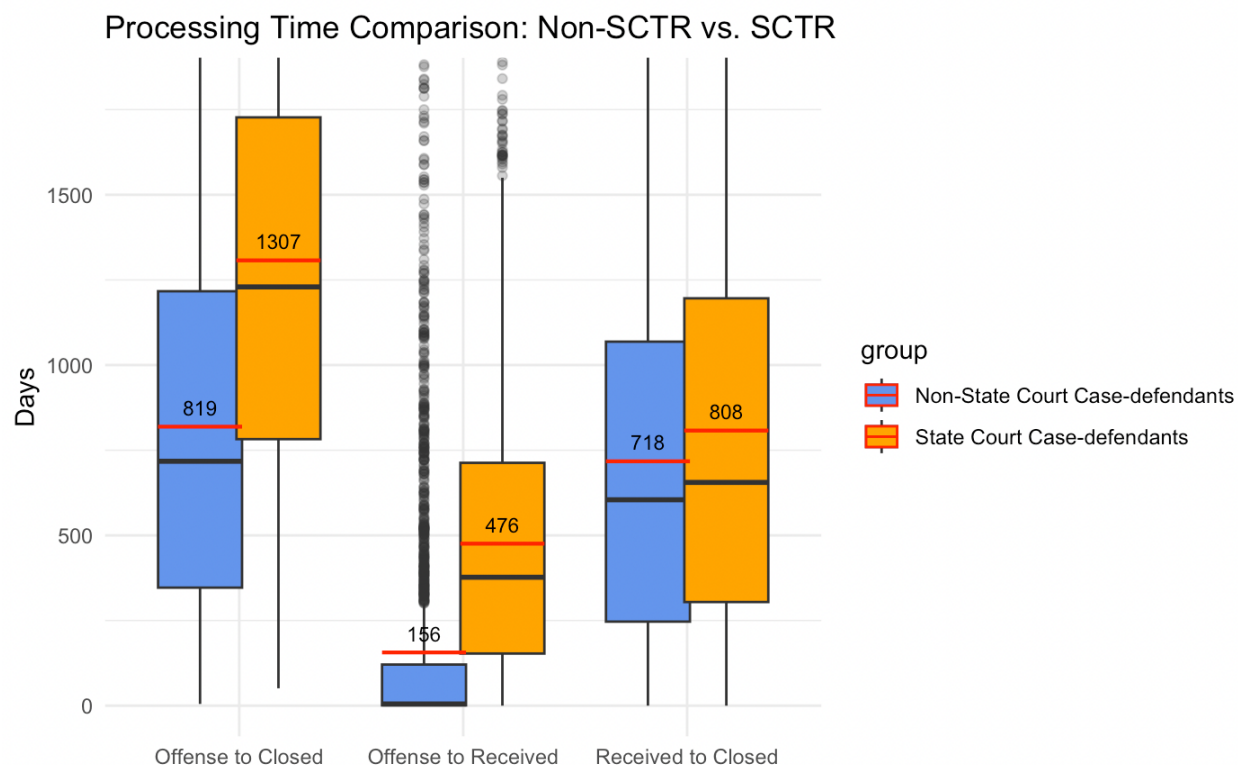
offense group makes up within all transferred charges, which helps highlight which offenses are most likely to be handed to the DA's office from State Court.

The results reveal that certain offense groups appear much more frequently than others, with assault and battery related offenses being the most common among transferred cases. Other categories, such as theft, traffic offenses, and property-related crimes, also appear but at lower proportions. This suggests that SCTR cases are not randomly distributed across offense types; instead, specific offense groups are more likely to escalate or require DA involvement.

Next, I wanted to look at the average number of processing days for SCTR case-defendants, and how that differs for non-SCTR case-defendants. Before comparing processing times, it is important to ensure that SCTR and non-SCTR case-defendants are comparable. Simply comparing these two groups would be misleading, since as shown above, State Court addresses lower-level cases (mostly misdemeanors elevated to felonies), while the standard, non-SCTR cases that the DA's office handles cover a broader range of cases (typically felony-level). Because misdemeanors generally have shorter statutes of limitations and may involve less complex processing, they would naturally have shorter timelines. As a result, any direct comparison would confound differences in case type with differences in case pathway.

To address this, non-SCTR cases were matched to SCTR cases based on offense group and number of charges, and were selected within a close range of offense dates. Overall, the comparison includes 1,800 SCTR case-defendants and approximately 2,500 matched non-SCTR case-defendants.

Figure 13. Comparison of Processing timelines between SCTR and Non-SCTR case-defendants



	Offense → Closed	Offense → Received	Received → Closed
Groups			
Non-State Court Case-defendants	≈2 years, 3 months	≈5 months	≈1 year, 11 months
State Court Case-defendants	≈3 years, 7 months	≈1 year, 4 months	≈2 years, 3 months

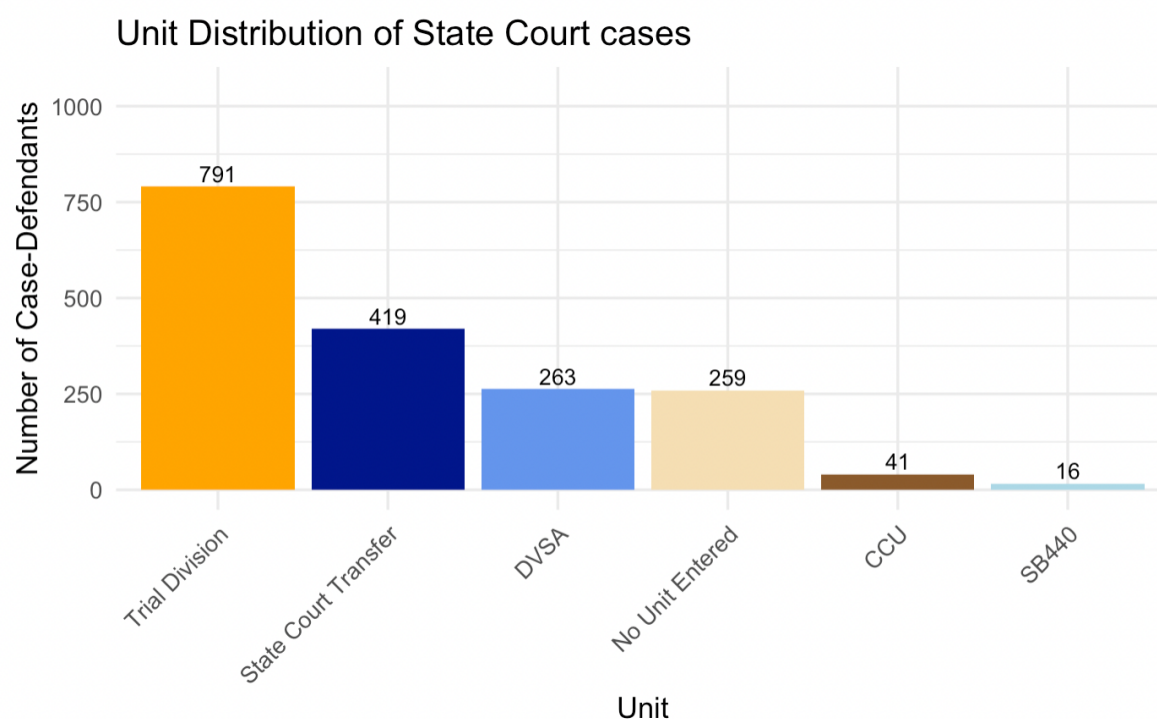
The results of this box plot reveal clear differences across the timeline, specifically for the process from offense to received. SCTR cases take substantially longer, but it reflects the fact that SCTR cases originate in State Court and are only transferred to the DA after some time has already passed. However, from receipt to disposition, the difference between the two groups is much smaller. Overall, SCTR cases still take longer from offense to disposition, but most of that

difference comes from the earlier stage when cases are in State Court and are being processed/transferred.

Statistical testing supports this interpretation. A Mann-Whitney U test was used to compare the distributions of processing times between SCTR and non-SCTR cases for each metric, since the data are skewed and contain many outliers. The results show that the differences in timelines are statistically significant across all stages. These results indicate that the observed differences in processing times between SCTR and non-SCTR cases are unlikely to be due to random variation and instead reflect consistent differences associated with the case pathway.

Now that we understand timing differences, where are these SCTR case-defendants ultimately handled within the DA's office?

Figure 14. Unit distribution of State Court cases within the DA's Office



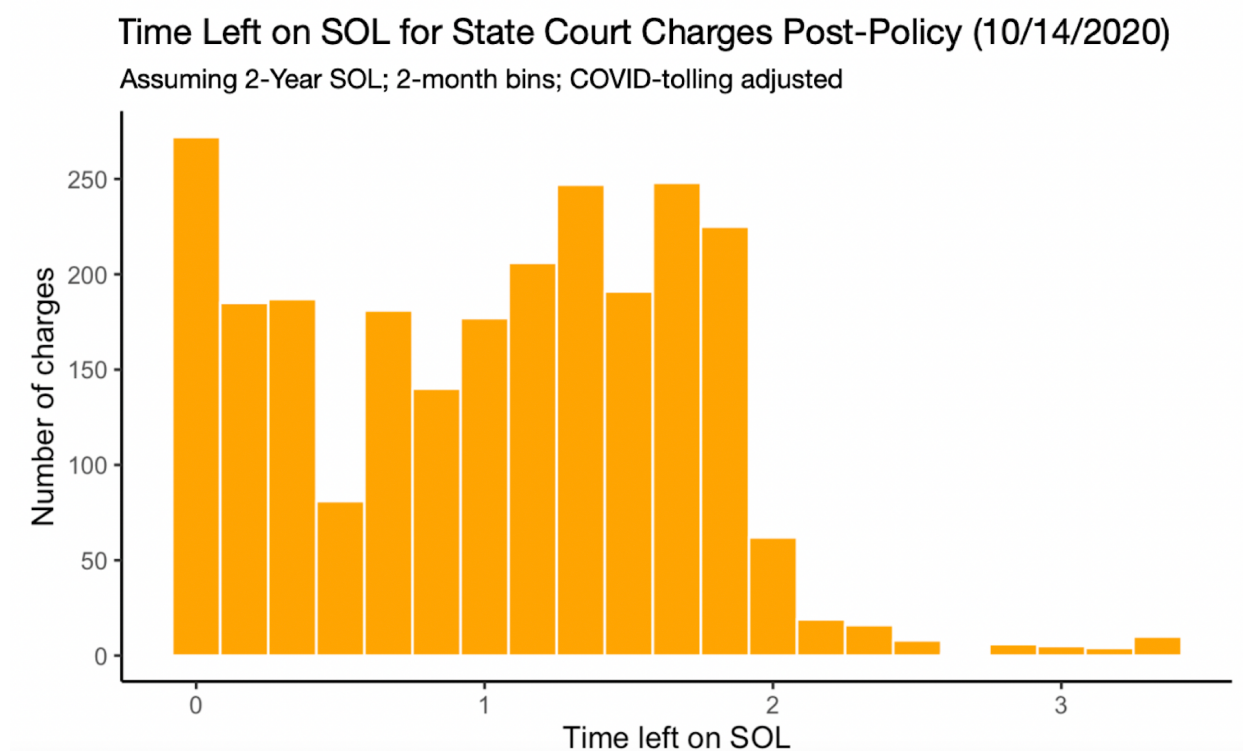
This bar plot shows how State Court Transfer case-defendants are distributed across different units within the District Attorney's Office. It focuses on the number of case-defendants assigned to each unit, highlighting where the majority of SCTR cases are being handled.

The findings reveal that the largest share of SCTR case-defendants, about 44%, are assigned to the Trial Division, making it the primary unit handling these cases. The next highest frequency is the State Court Transfer unit. During the preliminary hearing stage, charges may be reduced or dismissed if probable cause is not established. If so, the case is bound back to State Court for further proceedings. This explains why a noticeable portion of case-defendants return back to the State Court rather than continuing forward in the DA's system. The third most frequent unit is DVSA, which is also consistent with the offense composition of SCTR cases. As shown in the appendix, the most common offense type among State Court charges is "Battery - family violence", which is in the realm of the DVSA unit.

Overall, this distribution shows that while some SCTR cases are filtered out or redirected, a large portion still move into Trial Division. This suggests that SCTR cases contribute directly to the workload of trial line prosecutors, especially in areas where cases may already be more time-sensitive due to later entry into the system.

While the unit distribution shows where SCTR cases are being assigned to, it does not capture the timing constraints associated with those cases. To better understand the pressure these cases may place on different units, we examined how much time remains on the Statutes of Limitations (SOL) when they reach the DA's office.

Figure 15. Time remaining on the Statute of Limitations (SOL) Post-policy



The analysis includes only charges where either the transfer date or the received date occurs after the policy change. All charges are treated as having a 2-year SOL since charges originating from State Court are generally lower-level offenses and should not exceed that timeframe. Time remaining is calculated using the earlier of the transfer or received date, which represents the point at which the DA effectively becomes involved. COVID tolling adjustments are applied, and any negative values (cases appearing after SOL expiration) are set to zero to account for likely data inconsistencies.

With the assumptions in mind, the histogram displays the distribution of time remaining on the statute of limitations for State Court charges after the policy implementation (all accepted charges transferred from State Court after Oct. 14th, 2020). Most charges fall within the 2-year range, with a small number extending beyond 2 years due to COVID tolling adjustments.

The counts vary across bins rather than forming a smooth pattern, but overall frequencies decline as the amount of time remaining increases. A considerable number of charges are concentrated below 1 year left: the DA's office accepted 693 charges with 6 months or less remaining on their SOL, and 1,122 charges with at most 1 year remaining.

Because most post-policy cases follow the transfer pathway, the time remaining primarily reflects when the transfer packet is sent, rather than when the charge is reviewed and accepted by the DA. This means the actual usable time for prosecution may be even shorter than shown.

Takeaways

Although the State Court Transfer Policy provides a clear before-and-after comparison, we cannot conclude that the policy itself directly caused the observed changes in processing times. Other factors, such as changes in case composition or court operations over time, could also be influencing these patterns. Because of this, the results should be interpreted as associations rather than direct effects of the policy.

One key assumption in this analysis is that pre- and post-policy groups are defined based on timing relative to the policy change, rather than strictly by case pathway. As a result, some cases that follow pre-policy procedures (e.g., "taken" cases) may still appear in the post-policy group if their relevant dates occur after the policy implementation. However, this overlap is limited, as the majority of cases align with the procedural changes following the policy date. Additionally, cases where the transfer and received dates occur on the same day are considered uncertain in terms of pathway. These cases are classified as pre- or post-policy based on whether that shared date falls before or after the policy change. More broadly, the classification relies

heavily on recorded dates (transfer and received), which may not always exactly represent the actual sequence of events due to data entry inconsistencies or delays in documentation.

There are also limitations in the comparison between SCTR and non-SCTR cases. Although matching was done based on offense group, number of charges, and offense dates, there may still be unobserved differences between the two groups, like case complexity or quality of evidence. These factors could influence processing time, but are not fully captured in the data. Therefore, while the comparison provides useful context, it should not be interpreted as a perfect comparison.

In addition, the data contain a number of extreme values (outliers), particularly in processing time metrics. These outliers can skew averages and make timelines appear longer than what is typical for most cases. The presence of these extreme cases is important to keep in mind when interpreting average values. Similarly, for the pre and post-policy comparisons, COVID-19 overlap periods were excluded at the metric level to avoid distortion from shutdown delays. However, after applying these exclusions, the number of case-defendants remaining for certain metrics became relatively small, which may reduce the stability and representativeness of those averages.

Overall, the results show that the State Court Transfer Policy did not make cases faster or slower, but instead shifted where time is spent in the case process. After the policy, cases take longer to reach the DA's Office (offense date to received date), but once they are received, they are processed more quickly (received to disposition). This suggests that more of the case timeline is now occurring in State Court before transfer, meaning the DA is getting involved at a later stage than before. At the same time, SCTR cases still take longer overall compared to non-SCTR cases, but this difference is largely driven by delays before the DA receives the case, rather than

slower processing within the DA's Office. This highlights that the structure of case handoff (specifically when a case enters the system) plays a major role in shaping overall timelines. The SOL analysis adds an important layer to this. Post-policy charges are, on average, entering the DA's Office with less time remaining before expiration, indicating that charges are arriving later in their lifecycle and leaving less time available for review and processing. When this is considered alongside the unit distribution, it becomes more concerning. Since the majority of case-defendants are assigned to the Trial Division unit, many of the cases from State Court with tighter SOL constraints are being handled by trial prosecutors. This ultimately means that Trial Division is not only receiving a high volume of SCTR cases, but is also handling cases that are entering closer to the SOL expiration and may require quicker, time-pressured review.

V. Pre-Charging Unit

The implementations made by the District Attorney's office not only contribute to the well-being and benefit of the legal professionals working within the office but are also intended to serve the people who are interacting with the legal and juridical process as well. The District Attorney's office implemented the Pre-Charging Unit (PCU) in 2019 and later expanded it in 2022 to include more personnel. The unit consists of two functions: the prosecutorial arm, which sees a subset of cases from the point of receipt up until indictment, accusation, or dismissal for drug cases and low-level felonies on behalf of the Trial Division. Second, The investigative arm receives all cases that come into the District Attorney's office for two weeks, allocating time to investigation purposes. The purpose of this arm is so that decisions regarding case resolutions, such as whether or not to present them to the grand jury, can be made earlier in the judicial process.

The prosecutorial arm serves the purpose of alleviating the trial line by working to reduce backlogs that may be caused by trial attorneys being overburdened with their case load. For example, by not having to focus on a small subset of cases, attorneys and legal workers can then refocus their resources on addressing other cases that may demand attention. Additionally, with the PCU, it is more likely that interventions such as diversion and alternative sentencing options can be identified for defendants earlier in the judicial process. With this in mind, it would also be so that the prosecutorial function limits the number of cases that proceed unnecessarily to trial by identifying them with early resolutions at an earlier stage. The PCU prosecutorial function would ultimately be working for the benefit of defendants and their families, as well as lawyers and legal professionals, by providing a more manageable caseload structure that reduces attorney burnout and would ideally have a faster turnover rate in terms of case duration.

Additionally, the investigative arm of the Pre-Charging Unit is tasked with taking in every case for about two weeks to investigate and gather the necessary materials to help streamline the process of the case when it leaves the PCU. Though it is true that evidence may continue to be logged into the system after two weeks, the specific time period dedicated to investigating cases assures that every case receives a baseline level of inquisition before a charging decision is made, rather than allowing cases to move forward and having investigation occur in tandem with other legal processes. The investigative arm actively contributes to decreasing the trial line's burden by working to reduce the number of cases that are indicted and then later dismissed, which reflects badly on the district attorney's office by being a misuse of resources. To avoid this from happening, the pre-charging unit was intended to act as an early assessment of a defendant's background, history, and circumstances, as well as any additional form of information that contributes to forming an individualized and appropriate resolution to a

defendant's charge(s). The 14-day investigative period also reduces the investigative burden on attorneys by providing them with a baseline of information that helps them make decisions on their cases.

To assess whether or not the Pre-Charging Unit is performing as intended, the following questions were asked: How is The Pre-Charging Unit handling their case load? I investigated this question by visualizing the incoming and dismissed cases combined with a visual of pending cases. The second question asked was aimed at inspecting the investigative unit using the question: Throughout the duration of PCU evolution, what patterns have been observed in terms of evidence collected/logged, and the speed at which evidence is logged into Odyssey, the current management system?

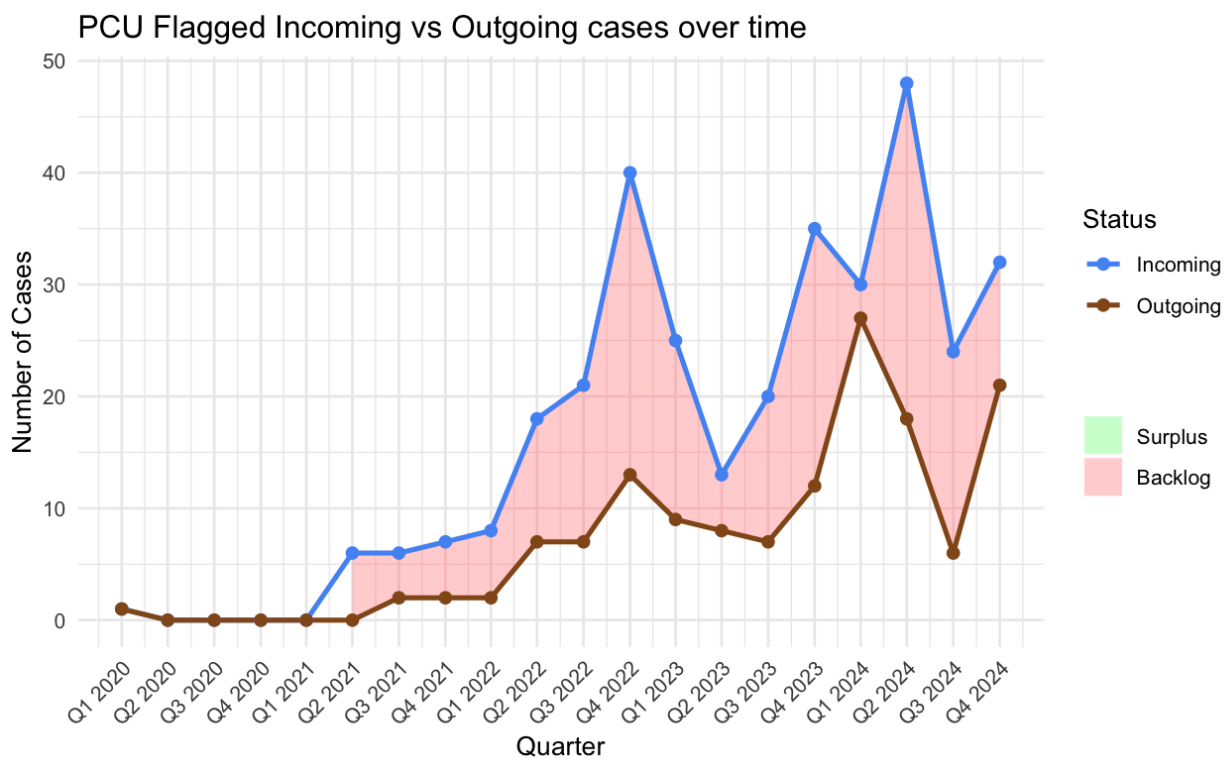
Main Results

Using the PCU-specific cases, we calculated the quarterly volume of incoming and dismissed cases which hinted towards a possible backlog that the PCU is facing. Dismissed cases are identified by the brown line, whereas incoming cases are marked by the blue line. If the gap between the lines is shaded red, that may serve as an indication of a growing backlog, meaning the rate of cases coming into the unit is faster than the rate of cases being dismissed. A green shading between lines would mean that the PCU is resolving cases faster than they are receiving them.

Both lines are around zero until the first quarter of 2021, which can be attributed to the shutdown as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic. Though there is a subtle rise in differences between incoming and outgoing cases, the gap does not begin to mark areas of concern until the shift in 2022, when the gap between incoming and outgoing cases continues to grow without

signs of narrowing. While there is a point in 2024 when the incoming and outgoing cases nearly meet, suggesting that PCU was momentarily keeping pace with its caseload, this was short-lived. Such results show that at very few points within the past years has PCU been closing cases faster than they accumulate.

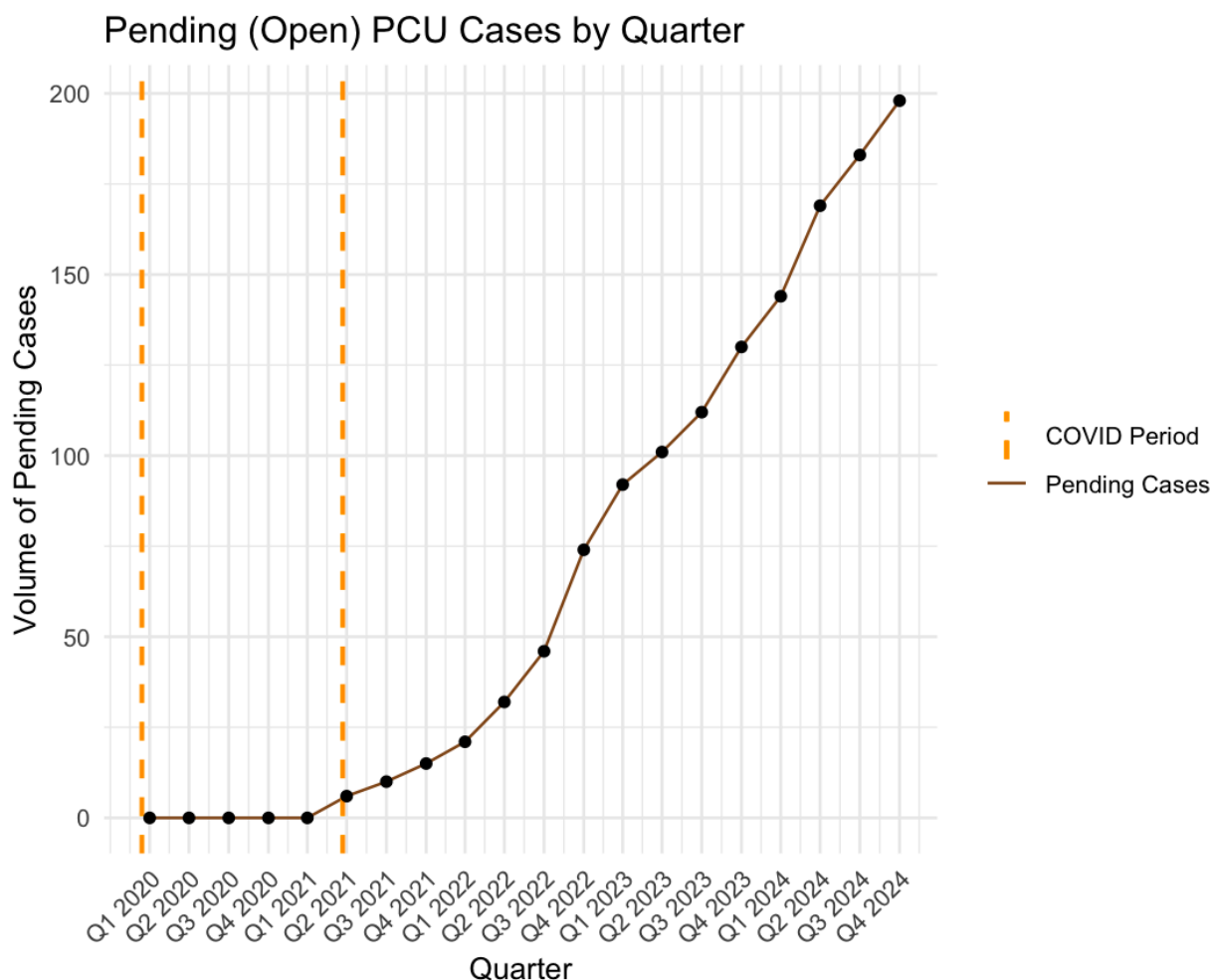
Figure 16. PCU Flagged Incoming vs. Outgoing over Time



Within the prosecutorial unit of the PCU, the incoming and outgoing cases are both growing over time; however, the incoming cases are growing significantly faster than the outgoing cases. It's likely that the Pre-Charging Unit is accumulating a backlog because cases are not being resolved at the same pace that they are being received. Seeing that such a backlog exists, we can conclude that while the PCU is doing its best to keep up with the case volume but may not have the capacity to keep up with the volume of incoming cases.

To capture a more indepth idea of the intensity of the backlog, I captured the pending cases that occur on a quarterly basis. For clarification, this graph is additive rather than providing a quarterly snapshot. So if a case came into the unit during quarter one and was still unresolved by quarter two it would be counted as pending for both periods.

Figure 17. Pending PCU Cases by Quarter

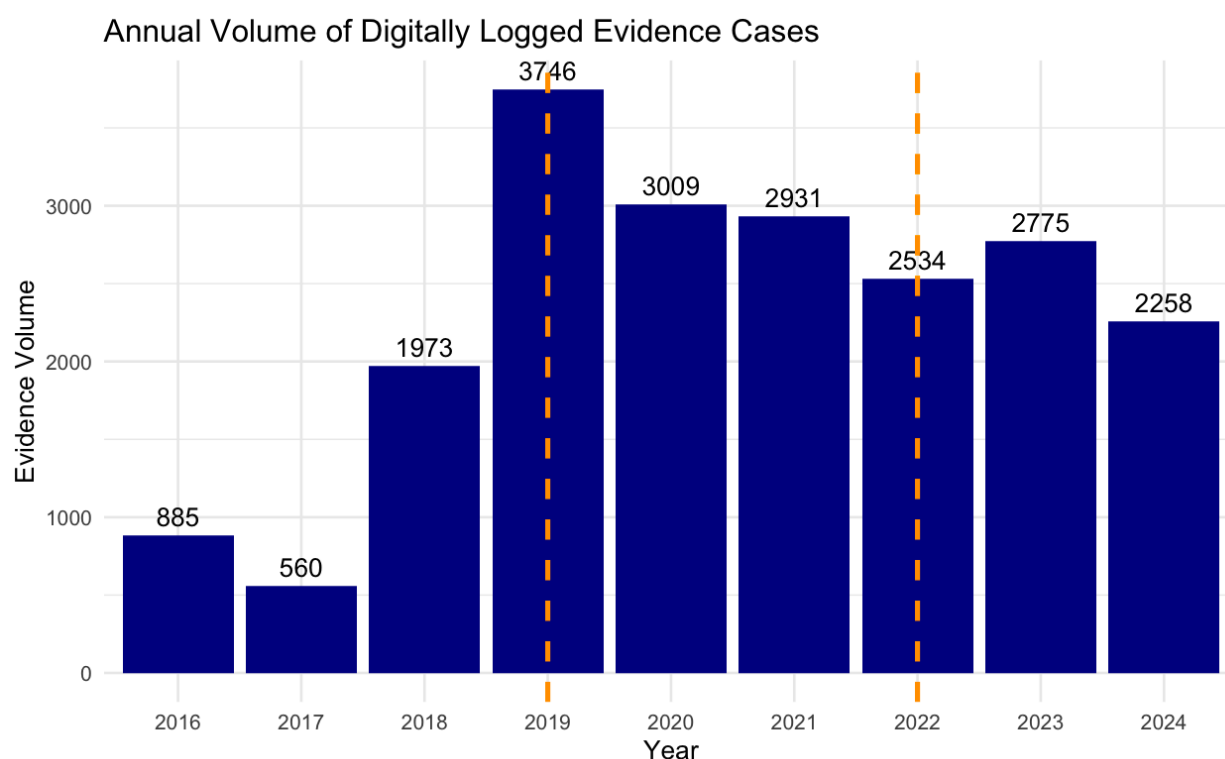


According to the data, the amount of pending cases is increasing per quarter. This growth is consistent with the red shading in the visual representing incoming and dismissed cases. because this represents the red shaded area in the graph above. The sustained growth indicates a gap between case intake and the time in which cases are indicted, accused, or dismissed. The

data suggests increasing pressure on the processing capacity of the pre charging unit, however one that may be resolved by increasing personal and resources.

To examine the investigative unit, I first started by providing a general visualization of the annual number of cases with logged evidence in the management system between 2016 and 2024. The dashed orange lines indicate the years in which the Pre charging unit was implemented and then later expanded.

Figure 18. Volume of Digitally Logged Evidence Cases Over Time

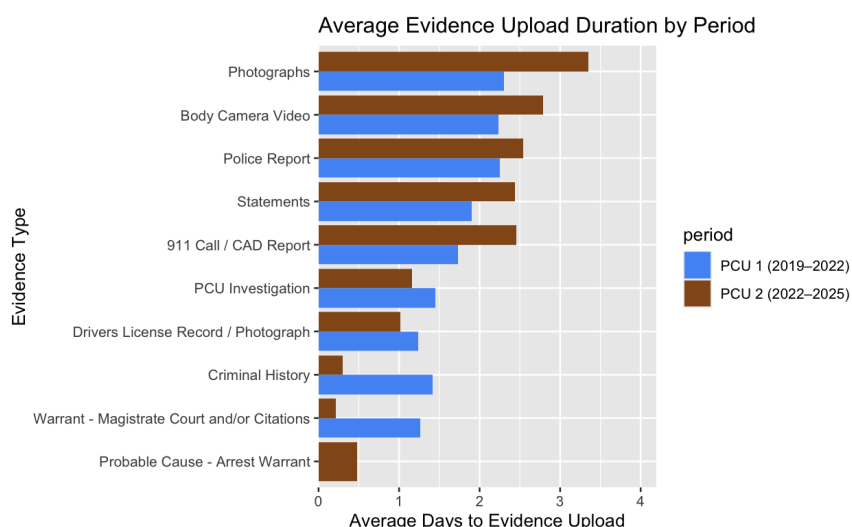


While Evidence was being logged prior to the PCU, there was a spike in the volume of cases digitally logged in 2019 when the Pre-Charging Unit was implemented by the District Attorney's office. From that point forward, the trend in the amount of digitally logged evidence is rather consistent.

Though this graph remains generally informative, we found it necessary to look more closely at the types of evidence being logged specifically within the two-week investigation window implemented with the establishment of the Pre-Charging Unit. To do this, we extracted the top ten types of evidence logged within the two-week window dedicated to investigation. The data shows that probable cause arrest warrants and warrants by the magistrate court were digitally logged the fastest on average. Such findings made sense, seeing that a warrant is needed in order for an arrest to take place. On the other hand, photographs and body camera videos take a longer time, which makes sense, seeing that it most likely takes time to be transferred from the police or from 911 to the District Attorney's office before being logged into Odyssey.

Knowing that the PCU was expanded in 2022, it was a place of interest to see whether the expansion impacted the efficiency with which evidence was being logged into Odyssey. The results were interesting. From this process, we found that little to no cases appeared in the Pre-PCU era; the filtering indicates that the implementation of the Pre-Charging Unit was what set the expectation for being more intentional about collecting data within a specific time window.

Figure 19. Average Evidence Upload Duration by Period



From the visualization, we see that data that typically takes longer to upload on average has increased in duration for the current era of the Pre-Charging unit. This may be attributed to a number of things. It could be that the unit is logging more evidence types that have longer processing times for example photographs and body camera videos. An additional hypothesis was that the unit may be coming into contact with more cases in the current era, causing them to move a bit slower. However, even with the slight decrease in speed, evidence is still being logged within the first week of a case being received, so it could be that the variation between the two units may be due to outside factors.

Due to the uncertainty regarding what is causing the difference in averages seen for some forms of evidence rather than others, we decided to use regression analysis to see if there is any significant difference between the two eras. Using an interactive model, we tested how the days to upload evidence varied for each unit depending on the evidence type. The results show that the expansion of the Pre-charging unit brought mixed results. Evidence types such as Criminal History and Warrants got meaningfully faster, possibly reflecting improved systems or processes for those record types. Meanwhile, physical or video evidence like Photographs, Body Camera Video, and 911 Call records got slower. This difference may be attributed to increased volume, or procedural changes in how evidence is digitally transferred and logged. While the cause of these differences may be attributed to forces outside the district attorney's control, we can conclude that the speed of evidence upload depends more on the type of evidence it is rather than the era.

Takeaways

To conclude, some functions of the Pre-Charging Unit contribute to workload reduction. However, not all of the functions work to resolve the underlying structural problem as intended.

The Pre-Charging Unit seems to be facing a backlog of its own in terms of PCU-flagged cases. This backlog leads us to believe that rather than alleviating the problem of the trial line being suspected of being overburdened in terms of caseload, the issue was more so relocated to another unit rather than being solved. One suggestion informed by the data would be to work on strengthening the task force of the PCU in order to be better equipped to address PCU-flagged case volume.

On a different note, the implementation of the investigative arm has been effective in establishing a baseline collection of evidence before cases proceed through the judicial process, supporting improvements to the timeliness of the prosecutorial indicator. That being said, if the PCU were to change structurally in how they use their resources, it should be done with this caveat in mind so that they don't shift resources away from the investigative arm at the expense of the prosecutorial arm and instead focus on strengthening both functions of the PCU.

VI. Diversion

The court diversion program serves as a pre-trial alternative to traditional criminal prosecution (*Pretrial Diversion | Cobb County Georgia*, 2026). The diversion process allows first-time or low-level offenders to avoid conviction by completing requirements like community service and counseling. Offenders will need the referral of the court to be enrolled in the diversion process. Upon successful completion of the requirements, the diversion process typically results in the dismissal of charges.

It is worth noting that enrollment in diversion does not guarantee a successful completion of the process. Because it takes time for people to finish the requirements by diversion, cases sent to diversion may take a longer time for the case to close, or any charges to be filed. In our analysis, we looked at the duration of cases that were sent to diversion, compared to those that

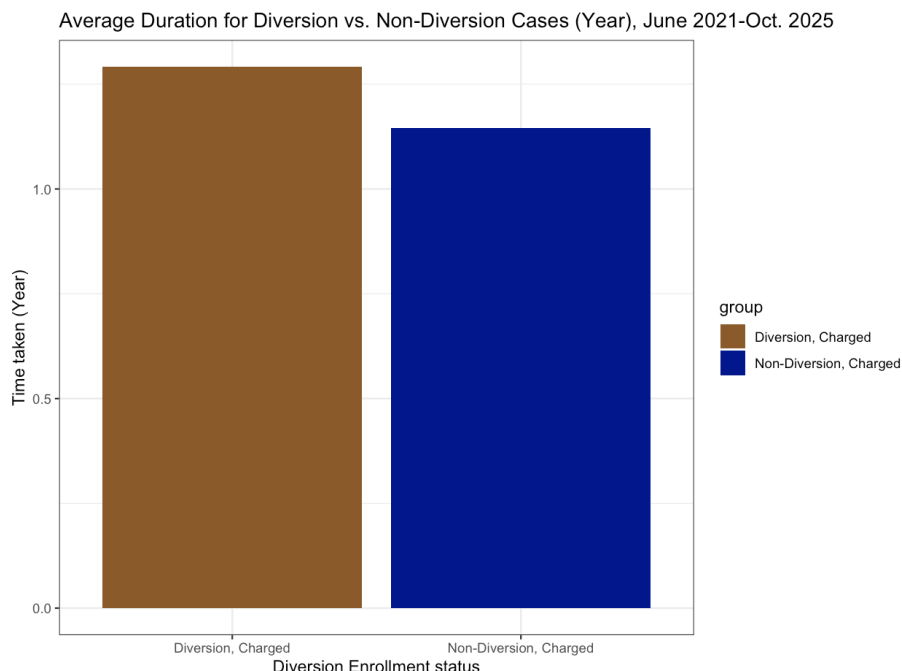
were not. This would give us a better understanding of how diversion potentially impacts the prosecutorial process.

Results

We calculated the average case duration for all cases that were either received or arrested after the office reopened in June 2021. Cases are only sent to diversion when the charge severity is low or when the defendant is a first-time defender. Therefore, all special unit cases or cases with severe charges like rape or murder will never qualify for diversion enrollment. Interested in seeing how diversion programs might have expedited or slowed down the judicial process, we only included cases with charges that would be potentially qualified for diversion. These excluded second-time offenders, any serious violent crimes, or serious violent felonies, ranging from trafficking, aggravated assault, to rape and murder. For non-diversion cases we deemed as potentially qualified, charges include burglary, threats, possession of drugs, etc.

Figure 20 shows the average case duration (from arrest to filing) between cases that were approved for diversion and those that never touched the diversion process. There is a statistically significant difference between the two groups (Appendix).

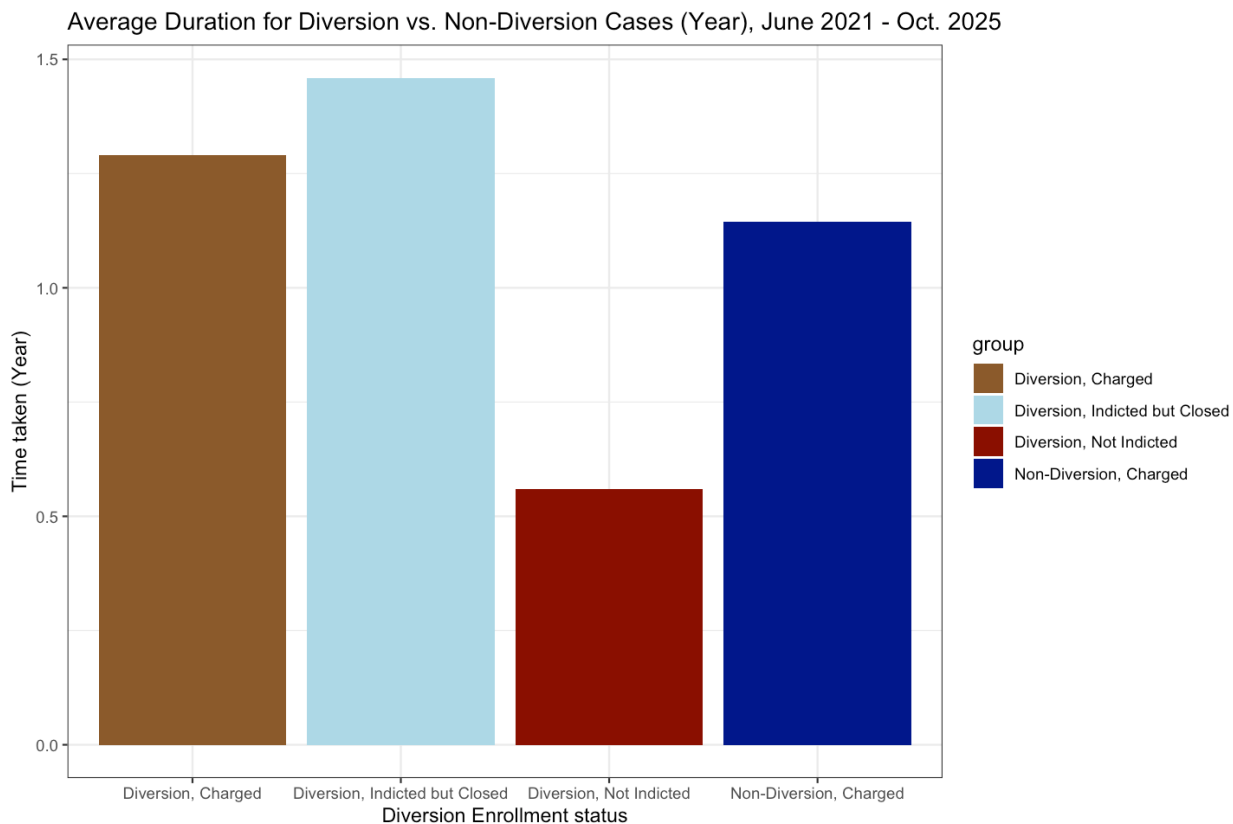
Figure 20. Average duration for cases in diversion, from June 2021 to Oct. 2025



Since many cases in the diversion program are not severe-level crimes, 57.8% of the cases did not have a date for arrest. For these cases, we used the time when the case was received as an imputation. Only cases with a valid filing date were considered “charged”.

For cases without a filing date, it is possible that the defendant is still finishing up the diversion requirements, or it could be possible that, upon completion of the diversion process, no indictment will take place at all. A majority of these cases (95.8%) have only the D-number, indicating that they never got indicted. For all cases without a filing date, we used the date when cases are closed as an imputation. Based on the type of case number (CR number vs. D number), they are labeled as “Indicted, closed” or “Not indicted, closed”. Figure 8 presents the average duration of cases across all four categories where a case could fall in, based on their diversion and indictment status.

Figure 21. Average duration for cases across groups, from June 2021 to Oct. 2025



It is intuitive to observe the “Diversion, not indicted” group with lowest case duration, given that corresponding defendants didn’t have charges associated with them upon completion of diversion. For the unexpectedly higher duration observed in “Diversion, indicted but closed” group, we speculated that it might be due to the significantly smaller sample size ($n=16$). More importantly, most of the charges associated with such cases involved abuse of the elderly or children. Since these cases involve family members and interpersonal relationships, it is reasonable to take longer than other cases in diversion, such as charges like theft and trespass.

It is worth noting that cases in recent years have a much shorter duration: this could be attributed to the fact that these cases happened more recently, and only the filed ones are documented. Overall, it takes significantly longer time for cases in diversion program to be filed, compared to those without engagement in diversion.

VII. Pending Cases

This section examines the pending felony caseload of the Trial Division over seven years from 2018 to 2024, tracking how workload per attorney position has changed over time. Additionally, the proportion of Trial Division cases that could qualify for reassignment to a special unit is analyzed to identify whether redistribution could serve as a viable path to reducing the Division's growing burden.

A pending case is defined as a case-defendant in which at least one charge has not yet been disposed of. The analysis operates at the case-defendant level rather than the charge level, meaning each unique combination of a case number and defendant is tracked as a single unit. A case-defendant is only classified as closed when every charge against that defendant has received a final disposition. If even one charge remains open, the entire case-defendant is counted as pending. Pending caseloads are the most direct way to measure whether the Trial Division is overburdened. Every case that enters the system but has not yet been resolved adds to the workload that prosecutors must carry, and a growing pending count signals that cases are accumulating faster than they can be closed. Tracking these numbers over time reveals whether the backlog is expanding, holding steady, or being worked down, and how disruptions like the COVID-19 judicial emergency have shaped the trajectory. Without a clear picture of how pending caseloads have evolved, it is impossible to evaluate whether the Trial Division has the capacity to manage its current responsibilities or whether structural changes such as additional hiring, case redistribution, or process reform are needed.

Cases remain pending for a variety of reasons that extend well beyond attorney performance. Court scheduling constraints, case complexity, and systemic disruptions, such as

the COVID-19 judicial emergency, all contribute to how long a case remains open. A high pending count for a given Division or position should not be interpreted as a reflection of the assigned attorney's competence or effort.

Results

Our analysis reveals a dramatic increase in pending caseloads over the seven years. In 2018, the average number of pending felony cases per attorney was in the single digits, though this low starting point likely understates the true caseload during the early years (2018-2019) since the analysis only includes cases that began after the DA took office and does not capture pending cases that originated before that point. Even with this caveat, a steady upward trend was already visible before COVID as cases entered the system faster than they could be resolved. The COVID judicial emergency in March 2020 accelerated this growth: with grand juries suspended and jury trials paused, cases continued to enter the system while almost none could be closed. As shown by Figure 23, by 2021 the average pending caseload had surged to over 500 cases per attorney. After courts reopened and jury trials resumed in June 2021, the numbers decreased only slightly and have remained elevated through 2024. The Division-level breakdown shows that the burden is not shared equally, as some Divisions carry substantially more pending cases than others. This unevenness should not be read as an indictment of the attorneys in those courtrooms, since case complexity, offense type, judge scheduling practices, and other factors not present in the data all influence how quickly cases move through the system. Cases assigned to Superior Pre-File, Superior Court, and State/ Magistrate Court are excluded from the Division breakdown because they fall outside the ten-Division structure.

Figure 22: Average Pending Felony Cases Per Attorney

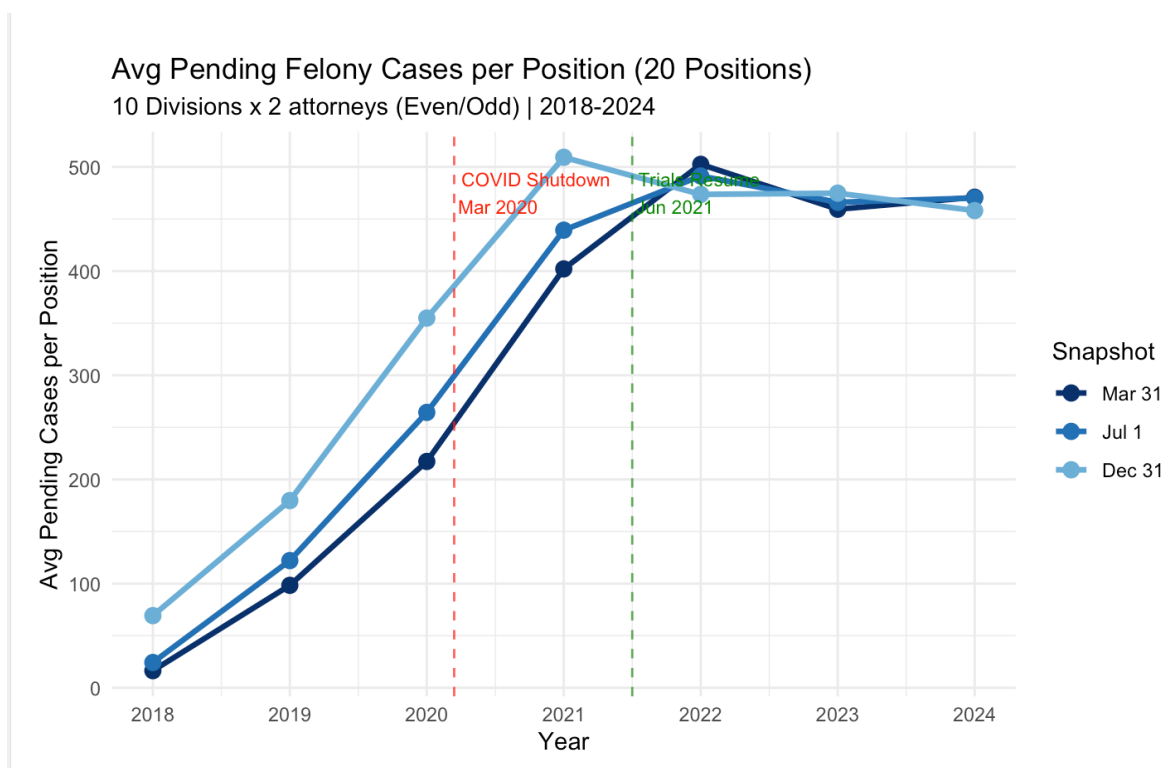
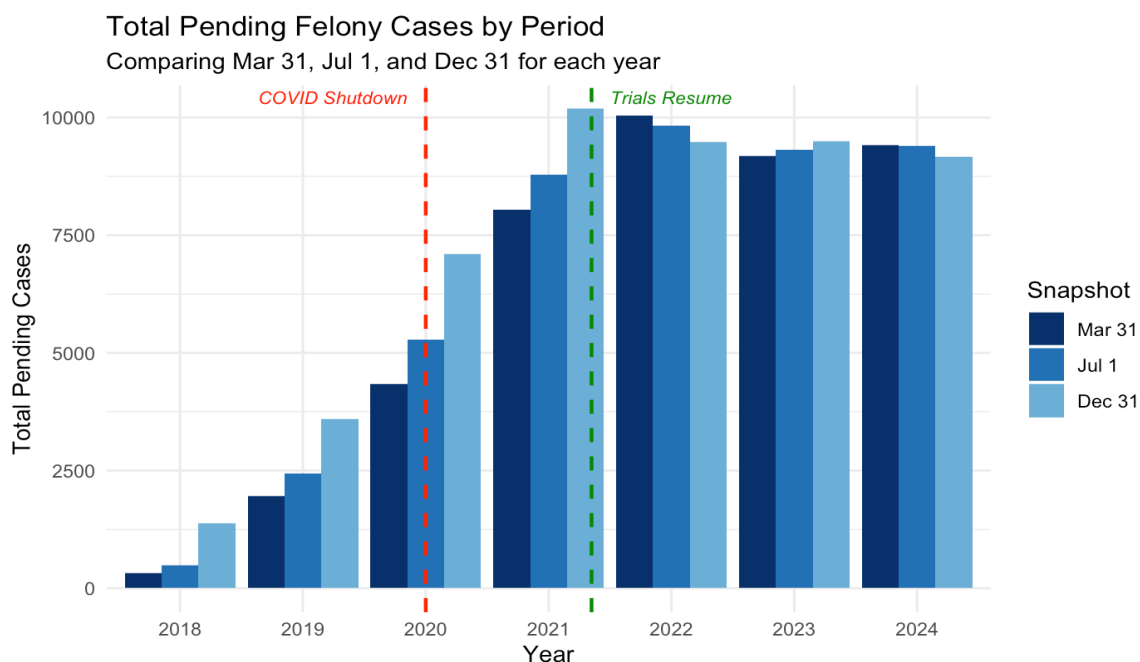


Figure 23 reinforces this trend through the lens of within-year variation. Before COVID, pending cases followed a predictable pattern: totals climbed from March to December as cases accumulated faster than they could be resolved. After the March 2020 shutdown, that seasonal growth accelerated sharply. Case resolutions stalled while new cases continued to enter the system, producing steep increases through the end of 2020 and into 2021. When trials resumed in mid-2021, the backlog did not unwind. From 2022 through 2024, the gaps between the March, July, and December snapshots have compressed. The system is no longer cycling between seasonal lows and highs. Instead, it is operating at a persistently elevated baseline, carrying a heavy caseload at every point in the year. It is also worth noting that attorney turnover is not visible in the data. For example, when a new attorney takes over a position, they inherit the pending caseload of their predecessor, which can inflate or deflate individual counts in ways that do not reflect their own performance.

Figure 23: Total Pending Felony Cases from 2018 to 2025



Takeaways

The Trial Division's pending felony caseload has grown dramatically over the past seven years. COVID was the primary catalyst, but the trend was already moving upward before the pandemic and has not returned to pre-pandemic levels since. The burden on the Trial Division is increasing over time, and that burden is not shared equally across Divisions. A chi-square goodness-of-fit test confirms that pending caseloads differ significantly across the ten Divisions, with some Division carrying significantly more cases than others (see Appendix for the full statistical results). These findings point to a structural workload problem that additional hiring alone has not resolved.

Special Unit Eligibility

As specified earlier, the DA's office operates several special units alongside the Trial Division, each dedicated to prosecuting specific categories of offenses. The Anti-Corruption Unit (ACU) handles complex white-collar crimes and police officer cases. The Child Crimes Unit (CCU) prosecutes offenses where the victims are children. The Domestic Violence and Sexual Assault Unit (DVSA) handles cases involving intimate partner violence and sexual assault. The Firearm Violence Prevention Unit (FVPU) focuses on gun violence cases. Cases are routed to these units based on the nature of the offense, with eligibility determined in part by flags recorded in the Offense Mapping table, provided by the DA's office. If a case meets the criteria for a special unit but is not routed there, it defaults to the Trial Division. We examine what proportion of the Trial Division's caseload could have qualified for a special unit based on offense code alone, providing a measure of how many cases share characteristics with those typically routed to specialized prosecutors.

Results

As we can see from Figure 27, across both currently pending and recently closed cases, approximately 87 to 89 percent of Trial Division case-defendants have at least one charge that meets the offense-based criteria for a special unit. The consistency between the two groups is notable. This is not a pattern unique to the current backlog or to cases that happened to close in a particular window. These figures represent a floor estimate, as the Offense Mapping flags capture only offense-code-based eligibility and do not account for intangible qualifying factors that the DA's office may also consider when assigning cases. The handbook explicitly notes that some

qualifying factors are not recorded in the case management system, which means the true proportion of eligible cases could be higher than what these numbers suggest.

Figure 24: Percentage of Trial Division Cases Qualifying for Any Special Units

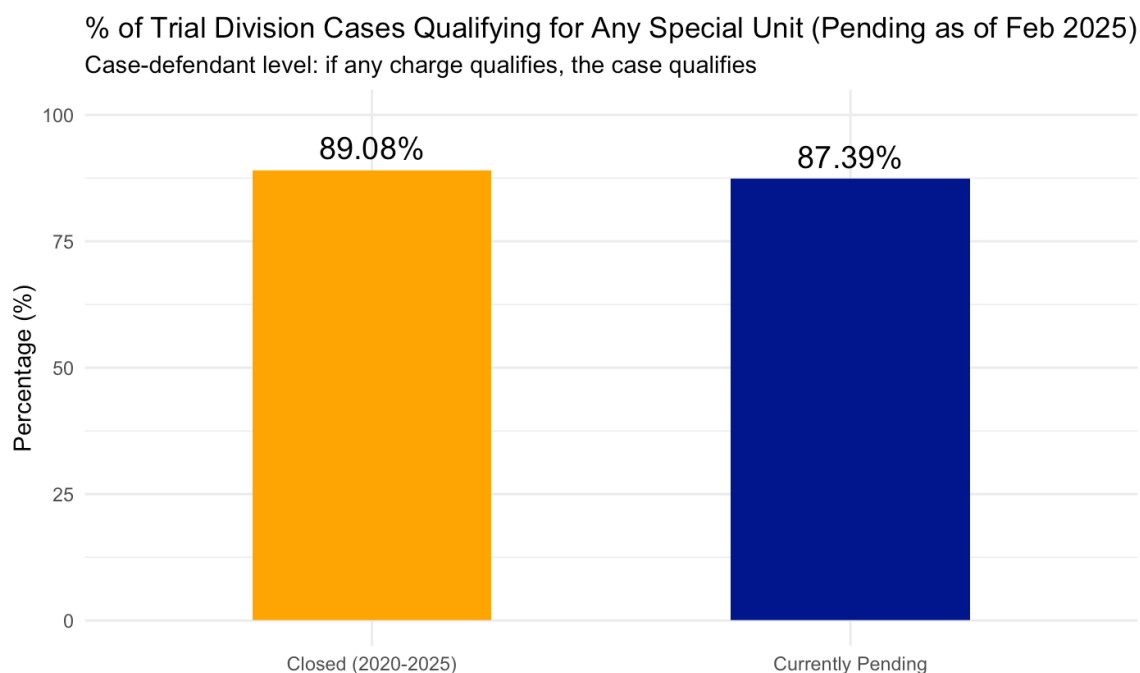
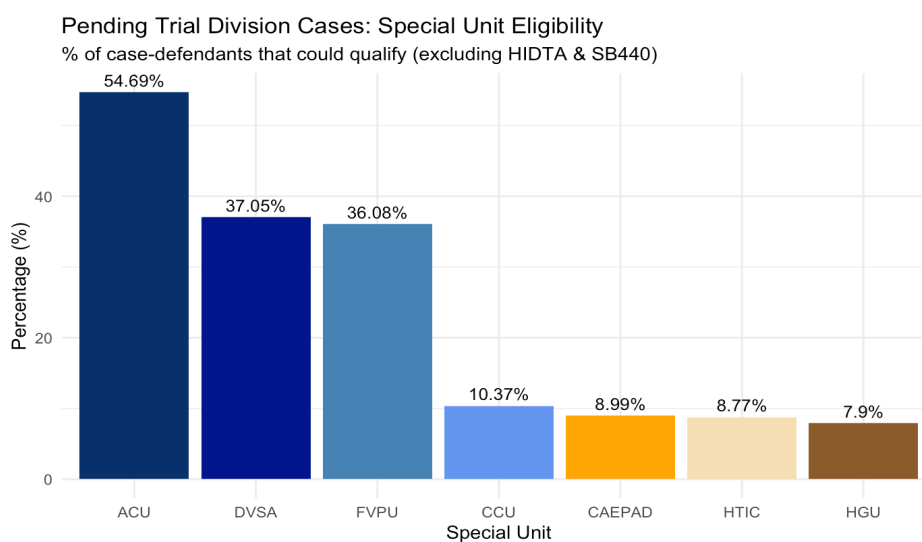


Figure 25 shows a breakdown of eligibility by individual unit. The Anti-Corruption Unit (ACU) accounts for the largest share at 54.69% of pending case-defendants, followed closely by Domestic Violence and Sexual Assault (DVSA) at 37.05% and Firearm Violence Prevention (FVPU) at 36.08%. Because a single case-defendant can qualify for multiple units, these percentages overlap and sum to more than the overall 87% eligibility rate. This overlap should not be mistaken for double-counting at the aggregate level. The concentration of eligibility in ACU, DVSA, and FVPU suggests that these three units represent the biggest opportunities for case redistribution away from the Trial Division. It is important to note that this analysis assumes

special units have the staffing capacity to absorb additional cases, which is a resource question that cannot be answered from the data alone. The number of attorneys assigned to each special unit is not captured in the data, and these units may already be operating at capacity. The Trial Division also exists by design to handle the majority of the DA's office felony caseload, so not every qualifying case should necessarily be redistributed. The goal of this analysis is to quantify the opportunity, not to prescribe a specific reallocation.

Figure 25: Special Unit Eligibility Across Pending Trial



Takeaways

A large portion of the Trial Division's caseload consists of cases that meet the offense-based criteria for a special unit. These cases are not anomalies. They appear at consistent rates across pending and closed cases, across time periods, and across both the Special Unit and Major Crimes categories. Redistribution of eligible cases represents a concrete, actionable path to reducing Trial Division workload. Combined with the findings from pending cases, which document a seven-year trend of growing pending caseloads that have not recovered from the COVID era, the picture is clear: the Trial Division is carrying cases it does not have to, and the

volume of cases it must carry continues to grow. Targeted reallocation to special units would reduce per-attorney caseloads, place cases with prosecutors who have subject matter expertise, and allow the Trial Division to focus its resources where they are most needed.

VIII. Scheduling

This section analyzes the relationship between judicial scheduling and court backlogs as measured through the case resolution times of Trial Division case-defendants. Furthermore, the connection between the scheduling of hearings and case-defendant resolution times will be explored.

Since this analysis compares differences between divisions, it is important to first understand the case assignment process. The first of two systems ensures an equal *number* of cases through a round-robin format; each division is assigned two cases (one per attorney) in sequential order. The second system is designed to provide each division with similar *types* of cases, as five wheels are spun corresponding to varying offense severities. Based on the quasi-random assignment of cases, we would expect to observe a lack of statistically significant differences in case-defendant durations across divisions.

In terms of judicial scheduling, each judge is responsible for determining the schedule of the cases assigned to their courtroom. Through the aforementioned assignment process, judges should hear an equal number of cases with the same severity of offense in expectation, except for the chief judge, whose administrative responsibilities result in them handling fewer cases.

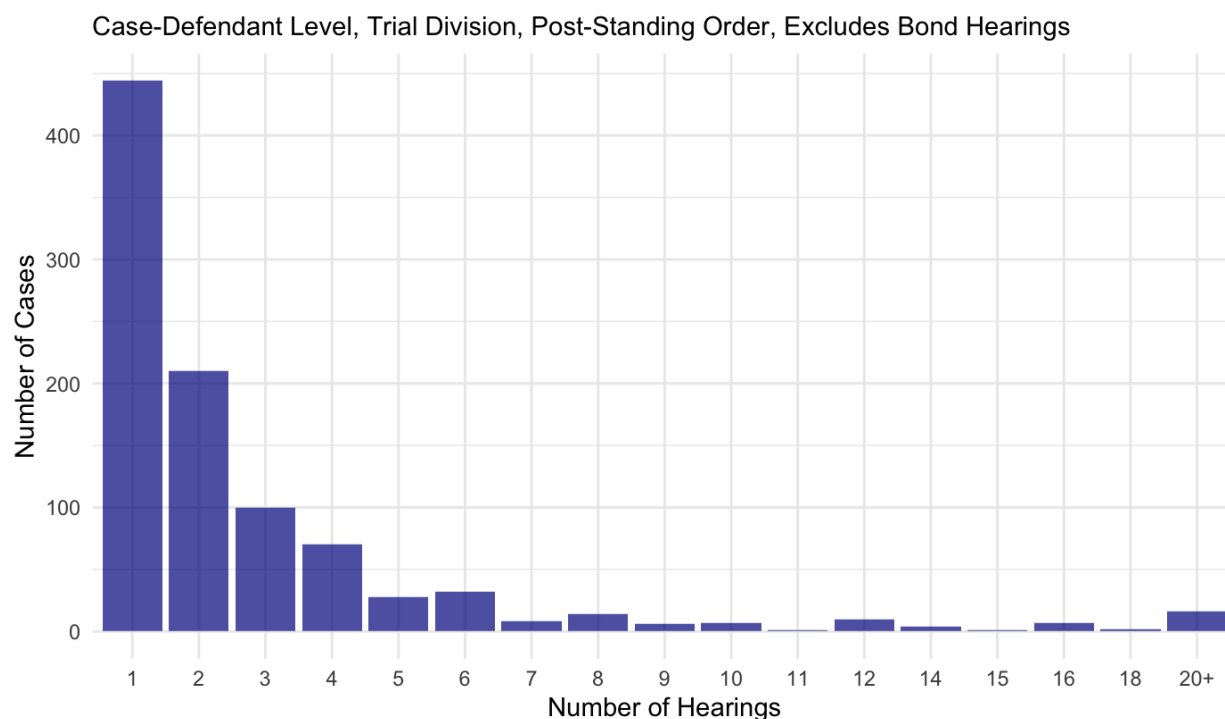
Case Durations

Once case-defendants are indicted, the next step in the criminal process is an arraignment hearing. At this hearing, the judge reads the charges, and the defendant enters a plea of not guilty or guilty. If the defendant pleads guilty, the case-defendant proceeds to sentencing and is essentially closed. However, if the defendant pleads not guilty, the outcome could result in a trial, where a jury or judge would deliver a verdict of not guilty or guilty. Regardless of the plea and the eventual disposition, all indicted case-defendants must be arraigned in order for it to progress or close. Notably, there is no strict, universal statutory deadline for case-defendants to be arraigned. Every post-indictment case-defendant has an arraignment, but some case-defendants have an additional hearing (or hearings) afterwards.

Results

Figure 26. *Distribution of Hearings Among Closed CR Case-Defendants*

(September 2022-October 2025)

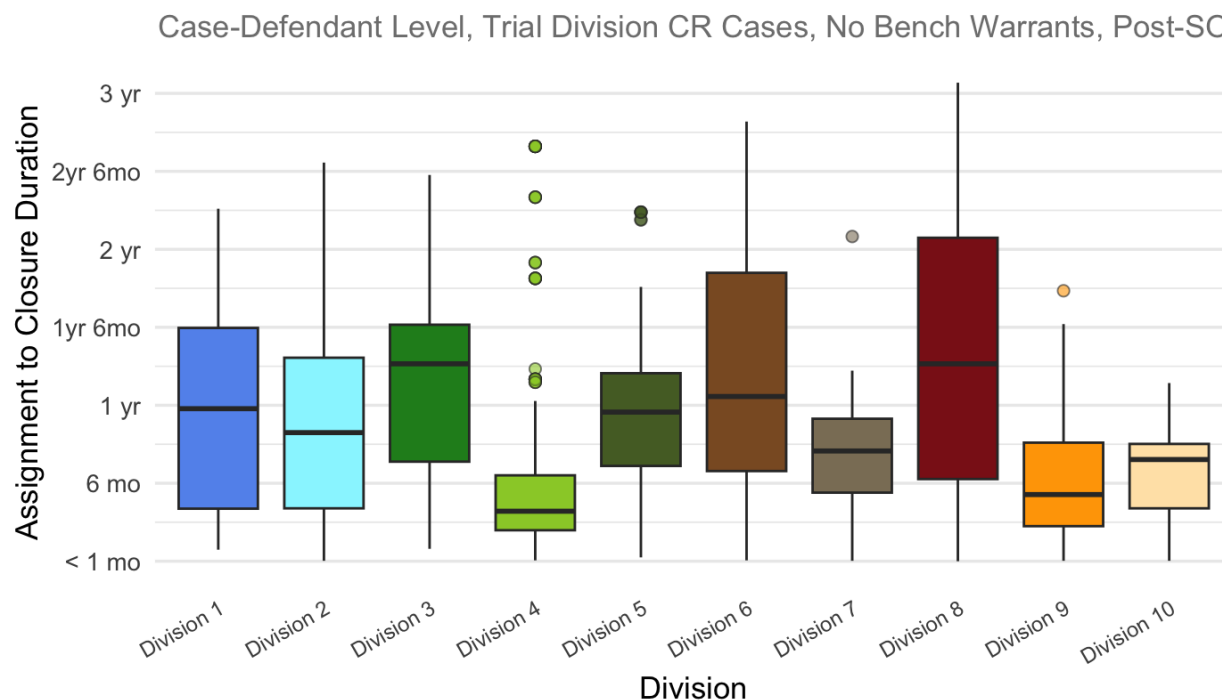


As Figure 26 indicates, the majority of Trial Division CR case-defendants that are indicted and ultimately closed tend to end in one hearing (46.3%). Some case-defendants have two hearings (21.9%), three hearings (10.4%), or four hearings (7.3%). Only 14.2% of case-defendants have five or more hearings. Although the mean is 3.2 hearings, this statistic is skewed by outliers, as there are case-defendants with upwards of 105 hearings. Therefore, a more appropriate metric is the median, which is 2 hearings. One important caveat with this analysis is that it excludes bond hearings and bond reduction hearings, as not every defendant is eligible for bail. Also, it is at the case-defendant level, so if a defendant has multiple charges, they are being grouped together. In terms of division differences, all divisions have a median of 1 or 2 hearings per case-defendant (see Appendix).

Average Case-Defendant Closure Time

The case-defendant closure time is calculated as the difference between the assignment date and the closure date. If a case-defendant has multiple assignment dates, the *earliest* assignment date is selected. Similarly, if a case-defendant has multiple closure dates, the *latest* closure date is selected. This way, the analysis accounts for the maximum time the defendant is within the criminal legal system. The average duration from assignment to closure at the case-defendant level is 291 days, or about 9.5 months. This statistic is skewed by outliers, as the longest duration is 1120 days, or over 3 years. Thus, a better metric is the median, which is 204 days, or about 7 months.

Figure 27. Time from Assignment to Closure by Division (August 2022-October 2025)



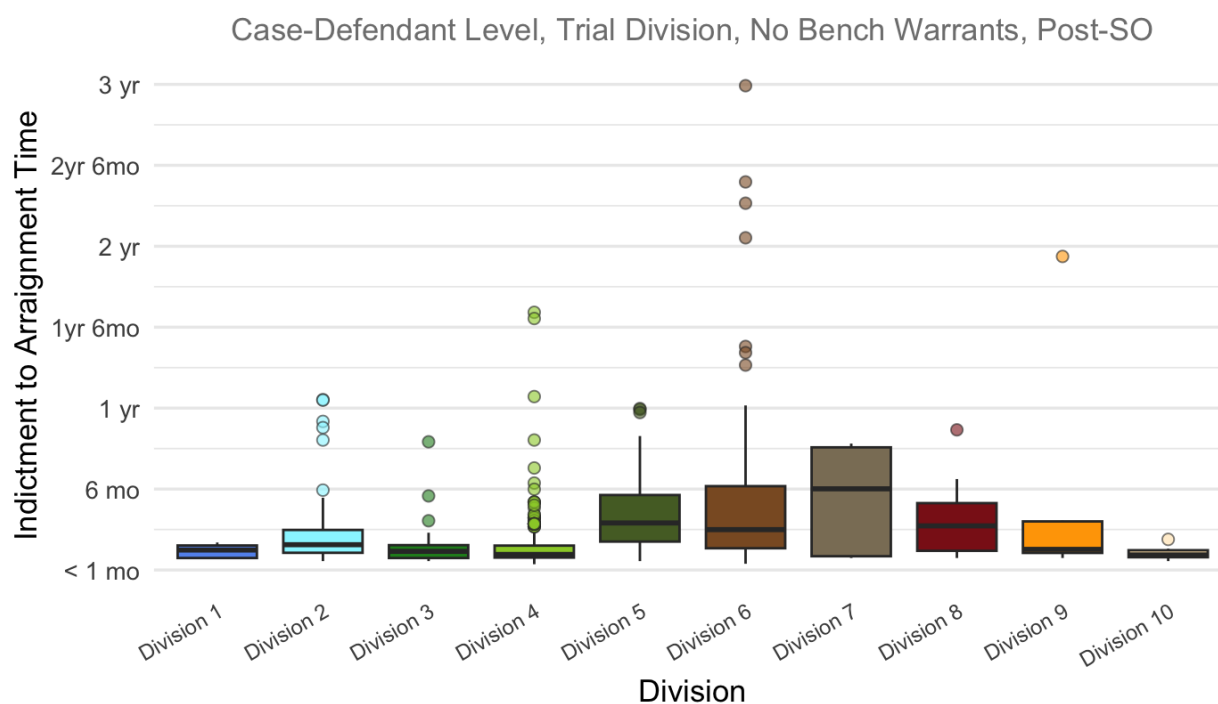
Using an ANOVA test (see Appendix), there is a statistically significant variation in case-defendant closure time across divisions (Fig. 27). Post-hoc testing revealed 24 statistically significant pairs of divisions, including Division 4-Division 1, Division 4-Division 2, and Division 6-Division 2 (see Appendix). On average, Divisions 4 and 9 close case-defendants in fewer than six months, while Divisions 3 and 8 require over a year and three months. Interestingly, Division 8 contains case-defendants that last beyond 3 years, even when filtering for bench warrants, which indicate the presence of an additional factor beyond the scope of ordinary scheduling. Because the data is post-standing order, COVID is being accounted for.

Duration Between Indictment and Arraignment

Beyond knowing that there are statistically significant differences across divisions in their overall closure duration, we are also interested in specific aspects, such as the duration from indictment to arraignment. Arraignment is important because it allows the criminal process to continue, regardless of whether a defendant pleads not guilty or guilty. For this analysis, if a

case-defendant has multiple indictment dates, the *earliest* indictment date is selected. Similarly, if a case-defendant has multiple arraignment dates, the *latest* arraignment date is selected. This way, the analysis accounts for the maximum time the defendant is within the criminal legal system. On average, indicted Trial Division case-defendants without bench warrants require 93 days (about 3 months) to proceed from indictment to arraignment. The mean is skewed by outliers, as the maximum duration is 1510 days, or about 4 years. As a result, the median of 48 days (about 1.5 months) is a more appropriate metric.

Figure 28. Time from Indictment to Arraignment by Division (August 2022-December 2025)



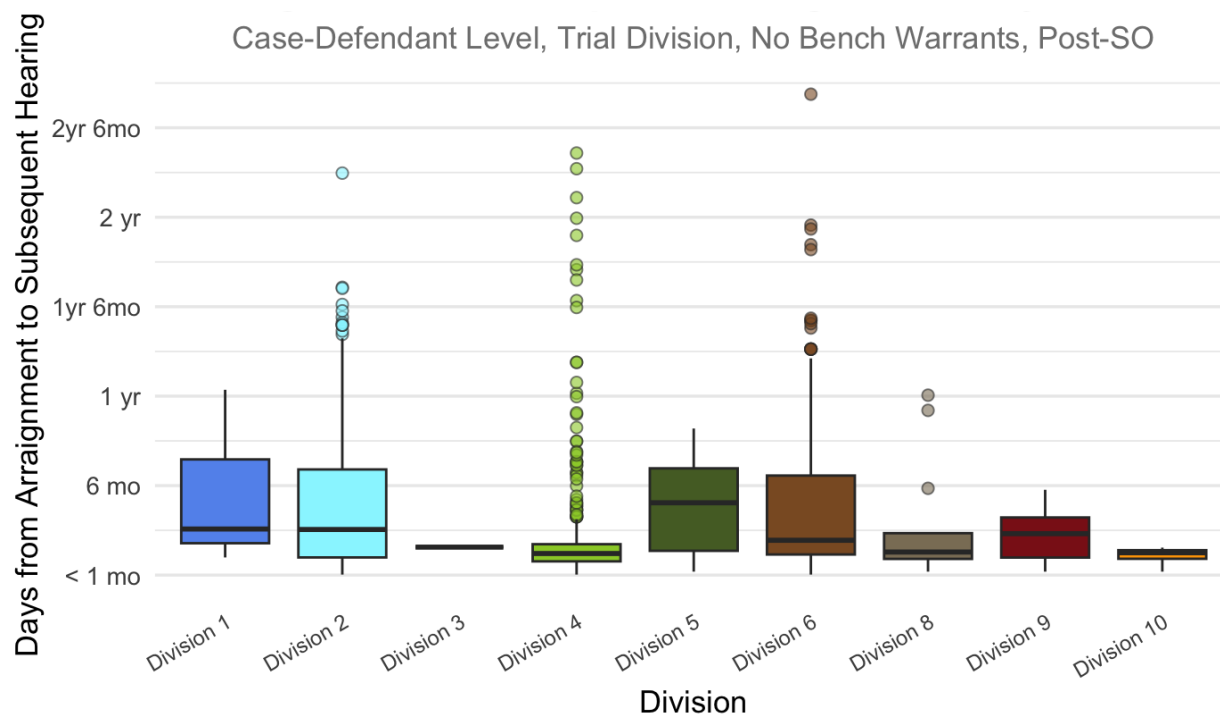
Using an ANOVA test (see Appendix), there is a statistically significant variation in indictment to arraignment time across divisions (Fig. 28). Post-hoc testing revealed 2 statistically significant pairs of divisions, which were Division 6-Division 4 and Division 6-Division 2. On average, Divisions 1, 2, 3, 4, 9, and 10 arraign case-defendants in fewer than three months, while Division 7 requires over six months. Division 6 contains one case-defendant that took 3 years to be arraigned, even when filtering for bench warrants. Because the data is post-standing order, COVID is being accounted for. The relationship between time to arraignment and overall duration appears to be intricate; although Division 7 takes the longest on average to arraign its case-defendants, it has one of the shortest average closure durations. The opposite is true as well, as Division 3 is one of the quickest to arraign, yet one of the slowest to close. There may be additional factors influencing both of these durations, meaning we cannot conclude a causal relationship exists.

Duration Between Arraignment and Subsequent Hearing

Beyond knowing that there are statistically significant differences across divisions in their duration from indictment to arraignment, we are also interested in the timeframe between arraignment and the subsequent hearing. This provides a snapshot of how consistent the post-arraignment processing times are, conditional on the existence of a subsequent hearing. For this analysis, if a case-defendant has multiple arraignment dates, the *earliest* arraignment date is selected. This way, the analysis accounts for the maximum time the defendant is within the criminal legal system. On average, indicted Trial Division case-defendants without bench warrants require 102 days (about 3 months) to proceed from arraignment to the subsequent hearing. The mean is skewed by outliers, as the maximum duration is 981 days, or about 2.5 years. As a result, the median of 49 days (about 1.5 months) is a more appropriate metric.

Figure 29. Time from Earliest Arraignment to Next Hearing by Division

(August 2022-December 2025)



Using an ANOVA test (see Appendix), there is a statistically significant variation in arraignment to next hearing time across divisions (Fig. 29). Post-hoc testing revealed 2 statistically significant pairs of divisions, which were Division 4-Division 2 and Division 6-Division 4. On average, Divisions 3, 4, 6, 8, 9, and 10 have subsequent hearings in fewer than three months, while Division 5 requires about five months. Division 6 contains one case-defendant that took almost 3 years to have a post-arraignment hearing, even when filtering for bench warrants. Because the data is post-standing order, COVID is being accounted for. Division 7 is not displayed because it did not contain any subsequent hearings within the filtered dataset. There appears to be a relationship between the duration between hearings and the overall duration; Division 4 is one of the fastest in both regards. By contrast, Division 5 is one of the slowest in both aspects, taking nearly 6 months between arraignment and subsequent hearing and requiring nearly a year on average for closure.

Takeaways

Trial Division CR case-defendants are typically closed within four or fewer hearings. There is a statistically significant variation between divisions in terms of case-defendant closure time, which could be driven by differences in post-indictment scheduling. Implementing a statutory deadline or recommendation in this regard could potentially assist in reducing delays. Future research should investigate the factors influencing this variation, including differences in caseloads across divisions.

IX. Outcomes

This section aims to answer the question: what are the differences in Trial Division case outcomes across divisions and compared with special units?

Outcomes represent case resolution and an overburdened attorney cannot spend the amount of time needed to provide a satisfactory outcome. So, to gauge the "success" of the Trial Line and Special Units I will use several different metrics to analyze case resolution and sentencing.

Cases can be resolved in several ways. They can be dropped, deemed non-guilty, or convicted. A conviction is a legal determination of guilt, through a plea or a ruling. A desirable outcome is to either drop a case or result in a conviction.

In order to understand more information about case resolution within the Trial Division, the category of Serious Violent Crime (SVC) was created to represent the various categories of serious crimes handled by the Division. Defendants initially charged with a SVC are defined as individuals charged with one or more of any of the following: armed robbery, kidnapping, aggravated assault, drug trafficking, and hijacking a motor vehicle.

Results

Figure 30. Defendant-Level Case Counts for Trial Division vs. Other Units

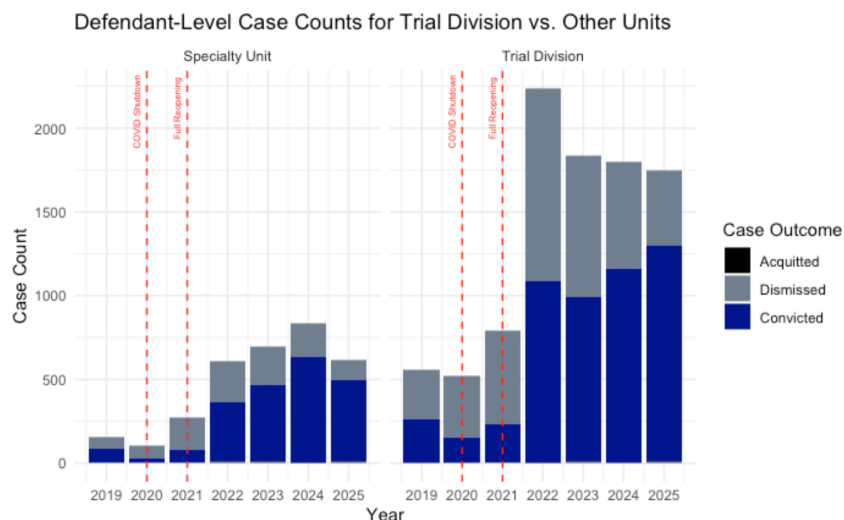


Figure 30 shows a stacked and faceted bar chart with two sections, one for Trial Division and one for all of the Specialty Units. dotted lines to represent the COVID shutdown, and the colors show if a case ended with a conviction or a dismissal. The Trial Division handles a higher number of cases per year and therefore has a higher conviction rate. There is some fluctuation across years, but Specialty Units stay relatively consistent and Trial Divisions' case count has increased since COVID.

Figure 30 shows all of the cases assigned to the Trial Division and Special Units regardless of whether or not they went to trial. A case was marked as a conviction if it had a guilty plea or ruling for any one or more of the charges. This shows that the Trial Division takes on and subsequently tends to convict more cases than the Specialty Units. In order to verify the significance of this difference, a Welch Two Sample t-test was run on the annual number of Trial Division cases and the annual number of Special Unit cases. It yielded a significant p-value of 0.01552. It is important to acknowledge that the number of years is limited, so the variation between years could slightly impact the reliability. Nevertheless, after this test, I am 95%

confident that the Trial Division handles between about 220 and 1558 more cases per year than Specialty Units.

Figure 31. Defendant-Level Trial Conviction Counts for Trial Division vs. Other Units

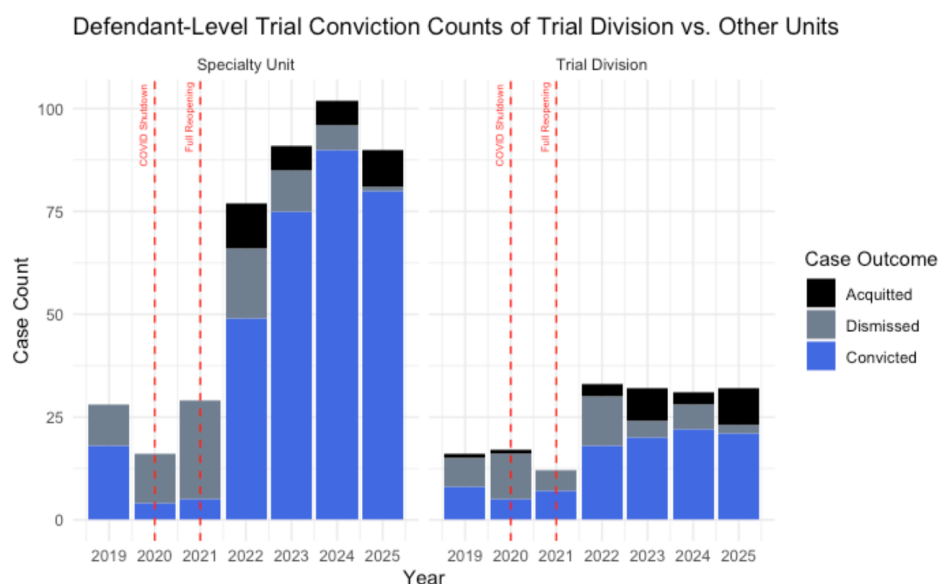
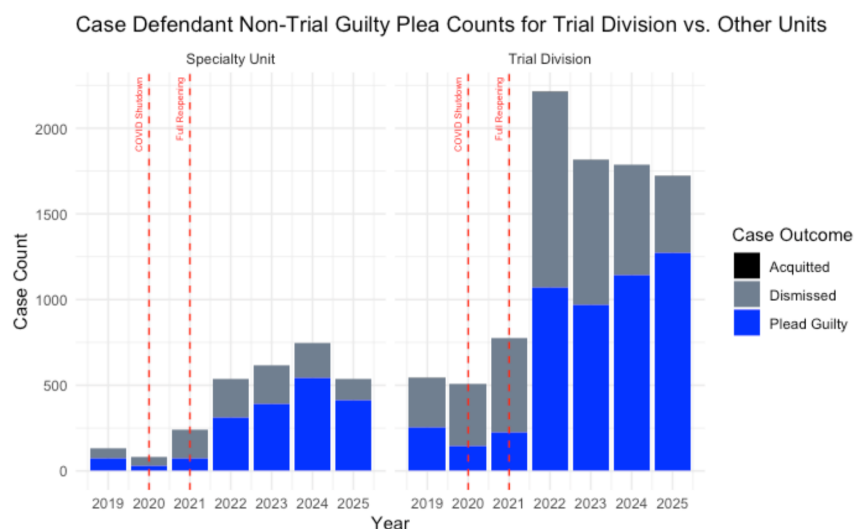


Figure 31 shows a stacked and faceted bar chart with two sections, one for Trial Division and one for all of the Specialty Units. Each section has a horizontal displaying the case count, a vertical line with the event year, dotted lines to represent the COVID shutdown, and stacking to show if a case ended with a conviction, dismissal, or an acquittal. The Trial Division handles a lower number of cases that go to trial each year and therefore has a lower conviction rate when considering only trials. There is some fluctuation across years, but Trial Division stays relatively consistent and Specialty Units' trial case count has increased since COVID.

In order to test the significance of the difference in tried convictions, a Welch Two Sample t-test was run on the annual number of tried and convicted Trial Division cases and the annual number of tried and convicted Special Unit cases. It yielded a p-value of 0.08747. Thus

this is not statistically significant. As a result, I cannot say that the difference in the number of convicted tried cases is not a result of random chance, just that there is a visual difference between the two.

Figure 32. Defendant-Level Non-Trial Guilty Plea Counts for Trial Division vs. Other Units



More specifically, *Figure 32* shows a stacked and faceted bar chart with two sections, one for Trial Division and one for all of the Specialty Units. Each section has a vertical line displaying the case count, an horizontal line with the event year, dotted lines to represent the COVID shutdown, and stacking to show if a case ended with a plea. The Trial Division handles more cases per year without a trial. There is some fluctuation across years, but Specialty Units stay relatively consistent and Trial Divisions' guilty plea count has increased since COVID.

Similarly to the previous visualization *Figure 34* has the same caveats, but it only looks at the cases that did not go to trial, excluding the cases that were tried. There is a massive difference between these two visualizations because most cases in the Trial Division are settled by plea instead of going to trial. Thus, in measuring the “successes” of Trial Division versus

Special Units, we recommend not using convictions in trials because this is unfair to Trial Division, who close many cases through guilty pleas

Within measuring the metrics of “success”, it is important to consider other ways to measure case outcomes, like through sentencing. Looking at the Trial Division sentencing, can help us to understand a key part of the judicial process and needs resources to be handled correctly.

Figure 33. Serious Violent Crime Sentencing Type by Trial Division

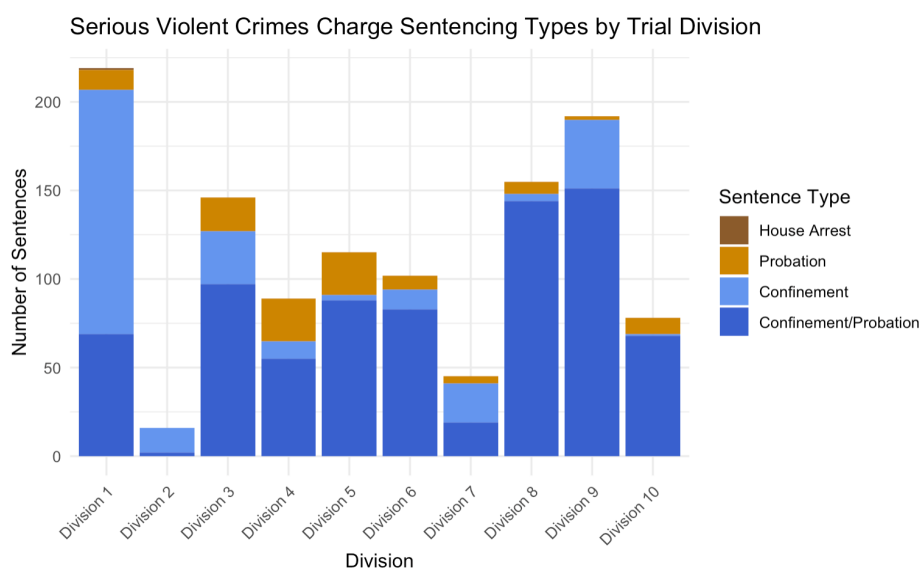


Figure 33 shows a stacked bar chart with a vertical line displaying the number of sentences and an horizontal line displaying the division. The majority of sentencing results in confinement or confinement/probation, but there is a good bit of variation and even a single House Arrest sentence.

This visualization shows the sentencing information for all of the SVC charges, this is one category of cases assigned to Trial Division, so they should not be proportionately spread across divisions.

Takeaways

The *Figure 31* further filters the data to show that more Speciality Units cases tend to go to trial than the Trial Division and, but they have a non-statistically significant difference in the number of tried cases convicted so this difference in conviction could be due to random chance. Nevertheless, special units are winning the cases that they take to trial and thus they will have better metrics on standard measurements of success such as the conviction rate.

However, this does not show the whole picture as Special Unit cases are generally more complex and more likely to go to trial. Thus, to help fill that gap, *Figure 32* shows that the Trial Division has many more cases resolved via plea before they need to go to trial. This shows that Special Units' higher trial conviction count cannot properly represent the units' outcomes, the Trial Division has an overwhelmingly higher number of cases that do not need to go to trial.

Thus, by resolving cases before they go to trial, the Trial Division is using its resources as efficiently as possible. Furthermore, *Figure 33* shows us that most but not all people are sentenced to confinement or confinement/probation. These are the complex SVC cases that took a lot of time and resources to take to sentencing. The variance in sentencing types indicates that sentences are being customized for each case.

There is more information on the offense specifics and offense time breakdowns in the appendix. But from this we can conclude that cases generally are given varied sentences.

X. Executive Conclusion

The overarching purpose of this project was to investigate how the Trial Division is performing using Prosecutorial Performance Indicators (PPI). These indicators consist of three main objectives. The first being Organizational & Staff Capacity, which assesses whether cases are being distributed evenly. The second being Timeliness of Case Processing, which seeks to address whether cases are being resolved efficiently. The third indicator addressed serious crime with the intention of answering whether or not defendants charged with violent crimes are being convicted. While the project took several different approaches to answering these questions by inquiring about different parts of the judicial process, we were able to form the following conclusions regarding the Prosecutorial Performance Indicators (PPI).

Starting with Organizational & Staff Capacity, our findings show that within the Trial Line, there is an intentional equal distribution of cases through quasi-random assignment. To put this simply, cases are being evenly distributed amongst attorneys by structural and procedural design. While it is true that the Trial Line is handling more cases than the Special Units, this cannot serve as a benchmark of proving that the Trial Line is overburdened because we lack enough information about the Special Units' capacity in terms of their personnel. So, having more cases does not necessarily indicate overburden so much so that it just describes the general case volume; however, some of the cases that Trial Line receives could be given to Special Units. Additionally, the Pre-Charging Unit is facing a backlog of one case in terms of the cases that they have removed from the responsibility of the Trial Line. Overall, we cannot draw conclusions about the capacity of the Special Units without information about their number of

personnel, nor can we make the assumption that the trial line is overburdened, seeing that there are so many nuances within the functions of the judicial process.

Regarding the timeliness of case processing, we found that with the implementation of the PCU investigative function that dedicates two weeks strictly to the purpose of investigation, evidence is being logged into the digital management system, Odyssey, more efficiently than before the implementation of the PCU. Additionally, while there is a high number of pending cases for the Trial Line, that rate is declining post-COVID. We also found that state court case transfers are given the shortest resolution window. Furthermore, there is a substantial variation between divisions when comparing their indictment to arraignment durations and post-indictment processing. While some divisions take longer to arraign, they can simultaneously have the quickest closure durations on average which reveal that the relationships between the time it takes for arraignment and overall duration are complex.

In terms of the last indicator that speaks to addressing serious crime, we found that the Trial Line and Special Units outcomes must be measured with different metrics. Using the convictions is an unfair metric to the Trial Division because they close many cases through guilty pleas. Thus, we cannot directly compare the success of the two types of divisions. Moreover, in the Trial Line, there are variations in sentencing across serious violent crimes.

Overall, we cannot definitively say that the Trial Line is overburdened, especially because of the visualizations that pointed to a decline in incoming cases. However, we broke the overarching question of the Trial Line being overburdened into different aspects within the juridical process, all of which have different outcomes due to the nuances within the judicial system. While the number of cases and pending cases is high, we cannot confidently say for sure that Trial Line is overburdened

Further Recommendations

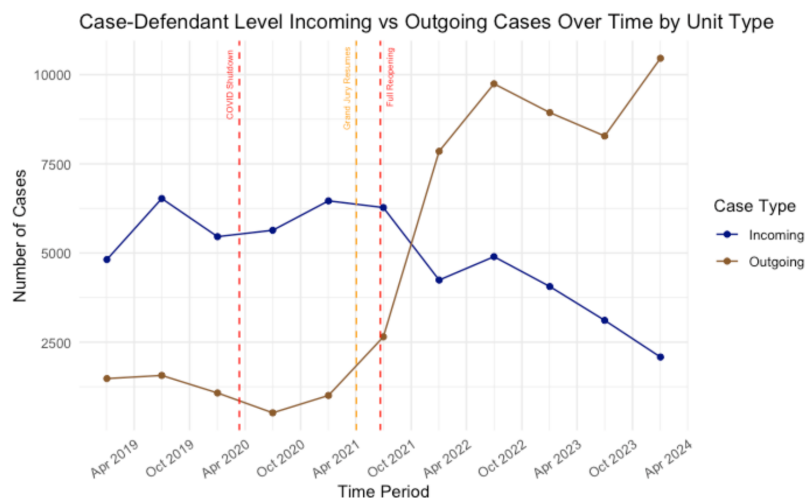
That being said, our analysis has provided us with enough evidence to provide the DeKalb County District Attorney's Office with recommendations to streamline the judicial process by further appealing to the three Prosecutorial Performance Indicators (PPI). The first suggestion is to redistribute cases away from the Trial Line and towards Special Units, as well as revise the state court transfer process. The differences between SCTR and non-SCTR cases are largely driven by delays before cases reach the DA's office, meaning that when a case enters the system significantly shapes its overall timeline. Post-policy cases are also arriving with less time before their statute of limitations expires, giving prosecutors less time to review and act. Although the state court processes cases relatively quickly once received, delays in reaching the DA office, combined with the trial division's high volume of SCTR cases, create significant time pressure on case review.

In combination with these suggestions, we recommend that adjustments to the pre-charging unit's prosecutorial arm be made in order to decrease the PCU backlog. Seeing that the investigative unit is functioning as intended, we raise the concern that any structural revisions to the unit's capacity to handle the PCU- flagged cases should be done without reducing resources from the investigative arm. Finally, our last recommendation is to create a standard for post-indictment scheduling due to the differences in indictment-to-arraignment duration. The implementation of a standard duration or deadline would work to ensure less delays. Furthermore, an interesting area for additional research would be to examine the factors influencing the variation in differences among the caseloads across divisions.

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1. Incoming/Outgoing Cases



Supplemental Incoming/Outgoing Cases Figure 1: Case-Defendant Level Incoming vs Outgoing Cases Over Time

Supplemental Incoming/Outgoing Cases Figure 1: shows a graph with two different lines showing the counts of incoming and outgoing cases. The visualization shows the number of cases vertically, time horizontally, and three dotted lines to represent the COVID Shutdown. The two lines show that the number of incoming cases has been somewhat decreasing over time and that the number of outgoing cases fluctuated. Initially and during COVID the number of outgoing cases were very low. But post COVID, there was a huge spike. After that, there was a bit of fluctuation, but still a generally higher level of cases closed.

This only counts each defendant's case once. Each cases' "incoming" information comes from the received date and the "outgoing" information comes from the event date. It does not include information about defendants persecuted by HIDTA and SB440 since they serve very specific categories of cases that are not applicable to the more general specialized units.

2. Case Distribution

Figure 1. presents the comparison in case distribution based on the time where cases are assigned to versus received by the unit. The comparison in trends shows suggestive evidence that, although the cases are still processed and sent to different units over the shutdown period, COVID-19 indeed slowed down the process of cases being assigned to respective units and moving forward in the judicial process.

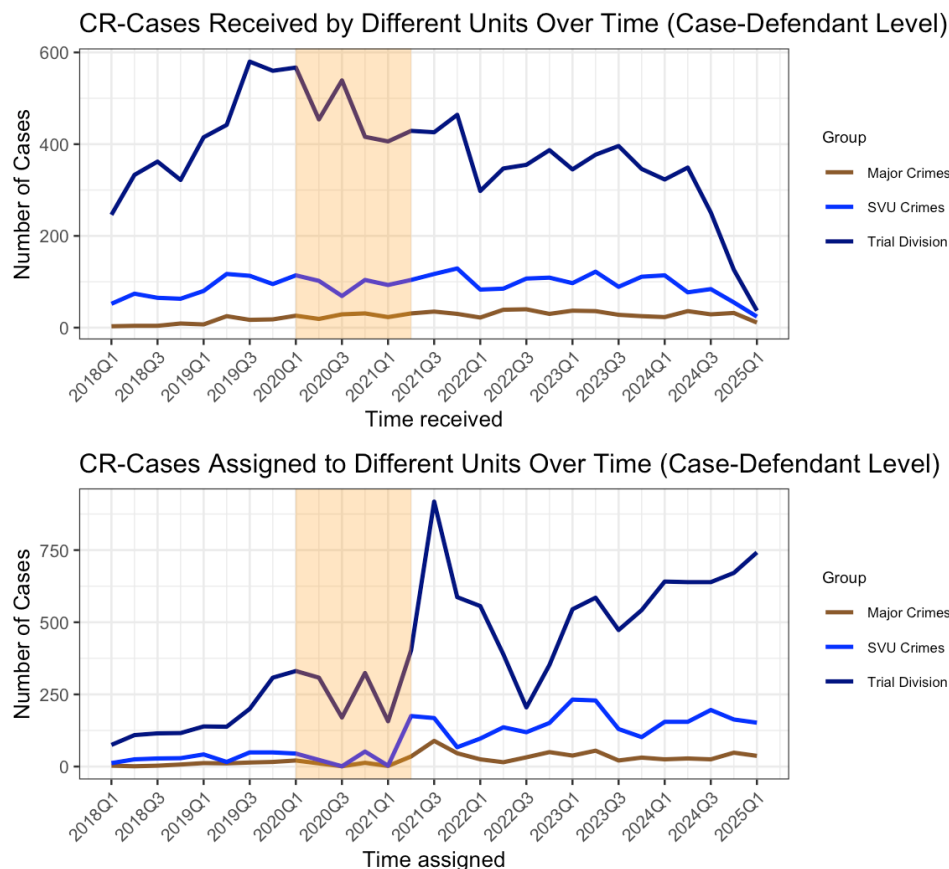
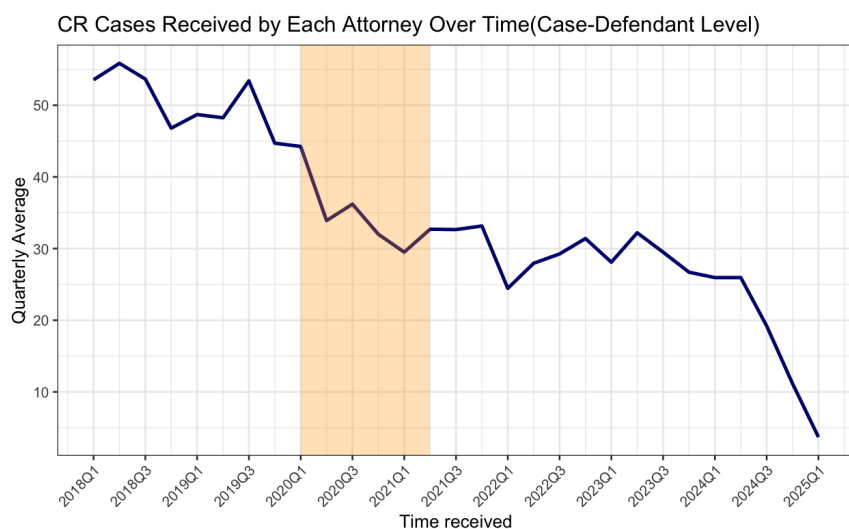


Figure 2. Case distribution based on assigned vs. received date, over time.

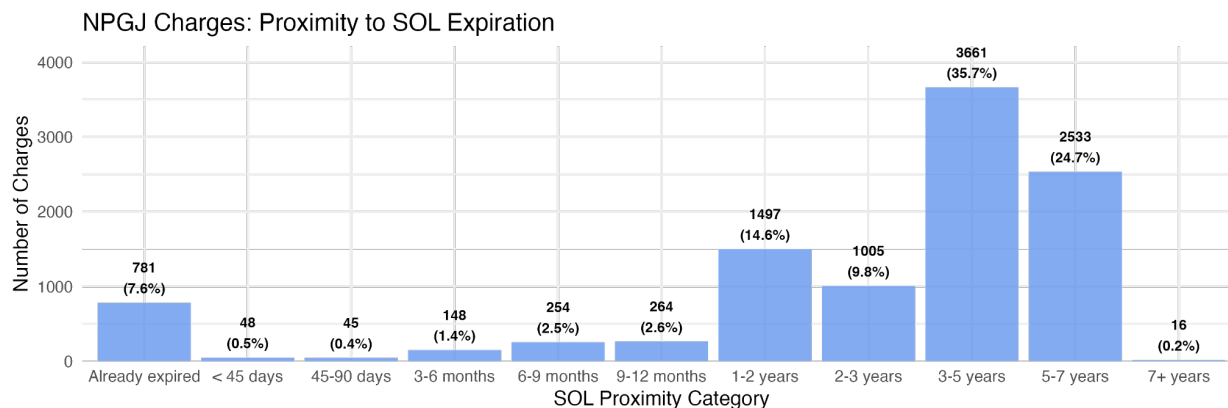
Supplemental figure 2 shows the average number of CR cases received by each attorney over time. Over time, it seems like the overall case load received by the DA's Office has declined.



Supplemental Figure 2 Average CR cases received by each attorney over time

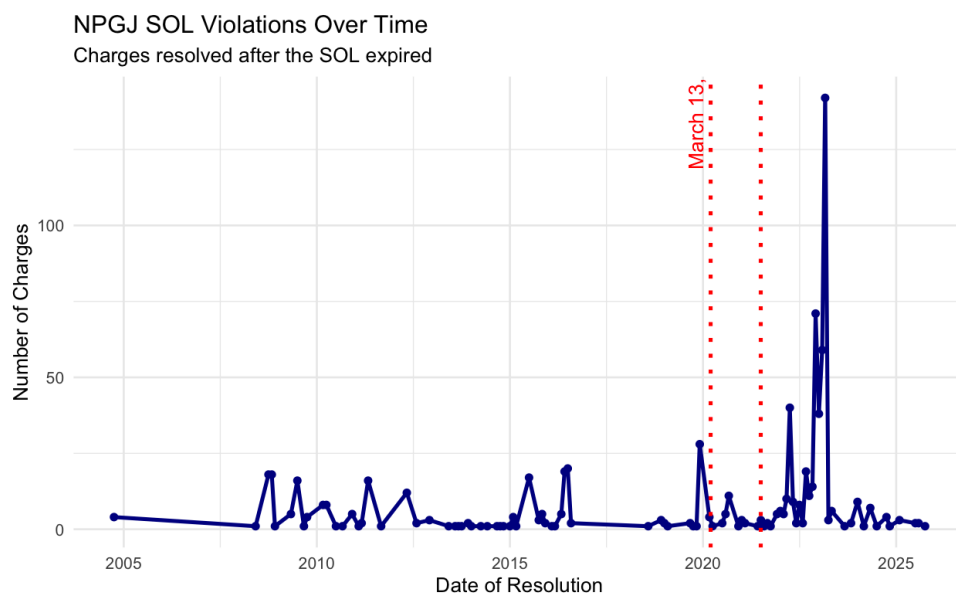
3. Statute of Limitations

NPGJ Charges and their Proximity to SOL Expiration



This visualization looks at the same relationship we looked at earlier, examining the proximity of the NPGJ by SOL over time, but in this visualization, it looks at the charge level, as opposed to the case-defendant level.

NPGJ with SOL Expiration over Time at the Charge-Level



This test looks at the same visualization from earlier of the proximity of NPGJ violations over time, but in this visualization, it looks at the charge level, as opposed to the case-defendant level.

4. State Court

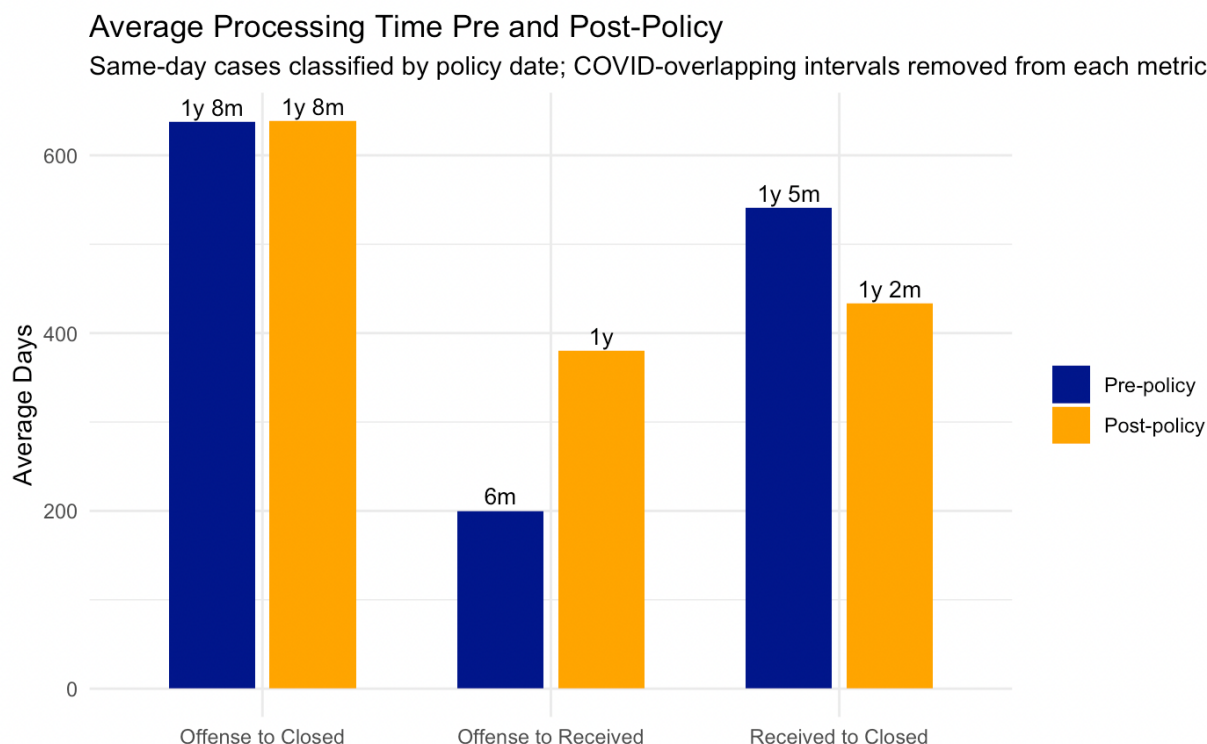
Statistical significance for differences between SCTR and non-SCTR case-defendants by metric

To formally test whether processing times differ between SCTR and non-SCTR case-defendants, a Mann-Whitney U test (Wilcoxon rank-sum test) was conducted for each stage of the timeline. This test is appropriate because the processing time data are skewed and contain many outliers, so they do not follow a normal distribution. Rather than comparing averages, the test compares the overall distribution of processing times between the two groups.

Metric	p-value	Interpretation
Offense → Received	< 0.001	Significant difference
Received → Closed	0.0496	Significant difference, but weak evidence
Offense → Close	< 0.001	Significant difference

The results show that there are statistically significant differences between SCTR and non-SCTR case-defendants across all stages of the case processing timeline. The table indicates that case-defendants in these two groups do not follow the same timing patterns.

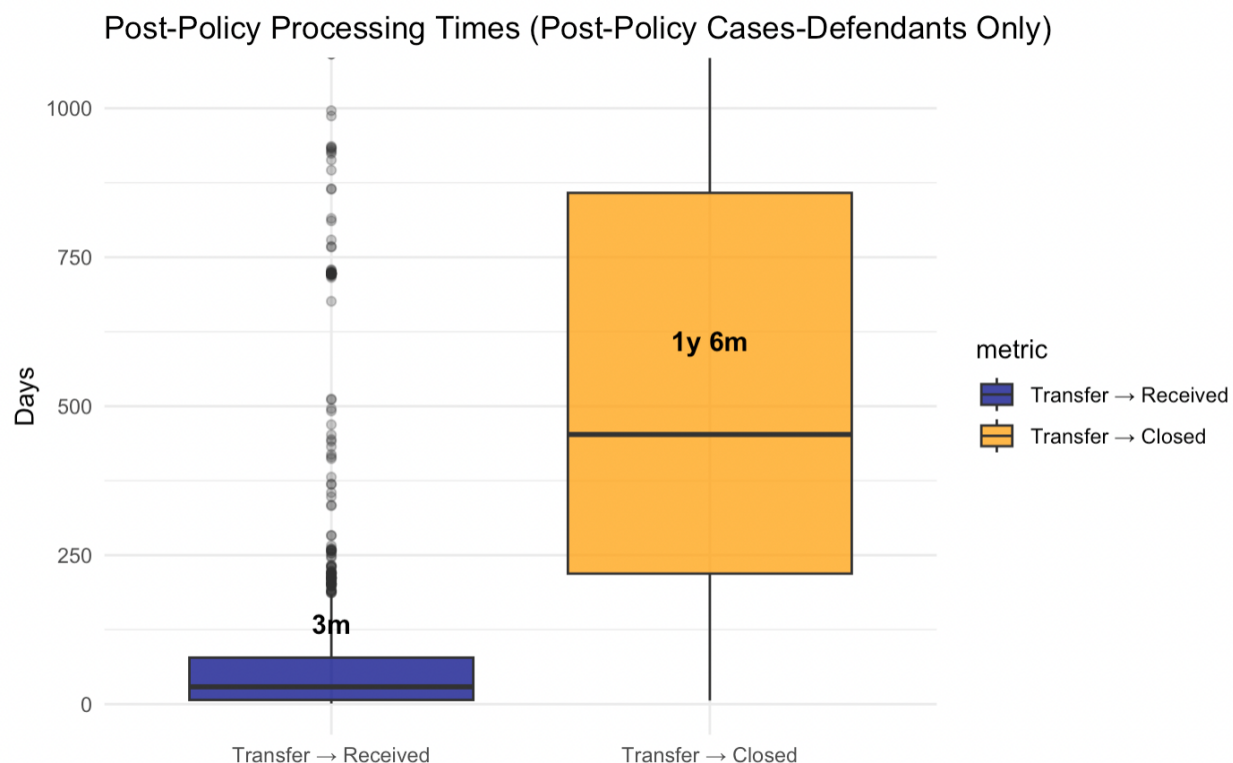
Pre vs. post-policy average processing days metrics (only State Court cases)



This bar plot compares average processing times for SCTR case-defendants before and after the State Court Transfer policy, using the earliest of the transfer or received date to classify cases as pre- or post-policy. Same-day cases are included and assigned based on whether that date falls before or after the policy change. To improve accuracy, COVID-19 effects are removed by excluding time intervals that overlap with the shutdown period for each metric.

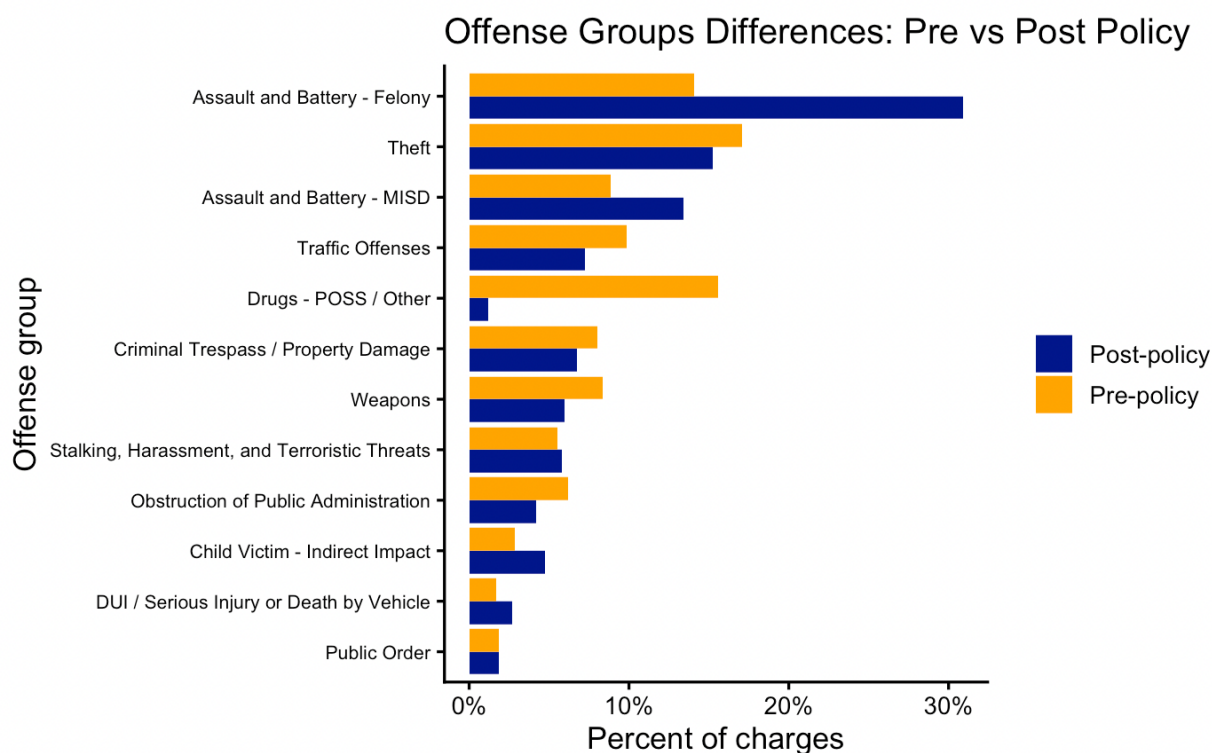
The results show a shift in where time is spent in the case process. From offense to received, post-policy cases take longer on average, indicating that cases are reaching the DA later in their lifecycle. However, from received to closed, post-policy cases are resolved more quickly than pre-policy cases. As a result, the overall offense-to-closed timeline is similar across periods, despite these differences. Together, this suggests that the policy did not reduce total processing time, but redistributed it: more time now occurs before transfer in State Court, while less time is spent within the DA's Office after intake.

Post-Policy specific timelines



To further understand post-policy processing, an additional metric was examined for transferred case-defendants: the time from transfer to received. This captures how long it takes for the DA's Office to receive the transfer packet, review it, and decide whether to accept the case-defendant. On average, this stage takes about 3 months, which represents the time between State Court initiating the transfer and the creation of a D# by the DA. The time from transfer to closed for transferred case-defendants has an average of approximately 1 year 6 months. This highlights that while the intake process itself accounts for a smaller portion of the overall timeline, there is still variability in how long cases take to be formally received after transfer.

Offense group composition differences between pre- and post-policy charges



This graph compares the distribution of offense groups between taken (mostly pre-policy) and transferred (mostly post-policy) charges, showing the percentage of total charges that fall into each category. Rather than focusing on counts, the graph highlights how the composition of offense groups differs across the two pathways. The results indicate which offense groups are more common in each group. For instance, assault and battery-related offenses make up a larger share of transferred charges that follow the transfer pathway, while categories such as drug possession/other appear more frequently in charges that follow the pre-policy pathway (DA takes the charge).

Test	Pearson's Chi-Square Test of Independence
Variable 1	Offense Group
Variable 2	Case Pathway (Taken vs. Transferred)
Chi-square statistic (X²)	501.95
Degrees of freedom (df)	32
p-value	< 0.001

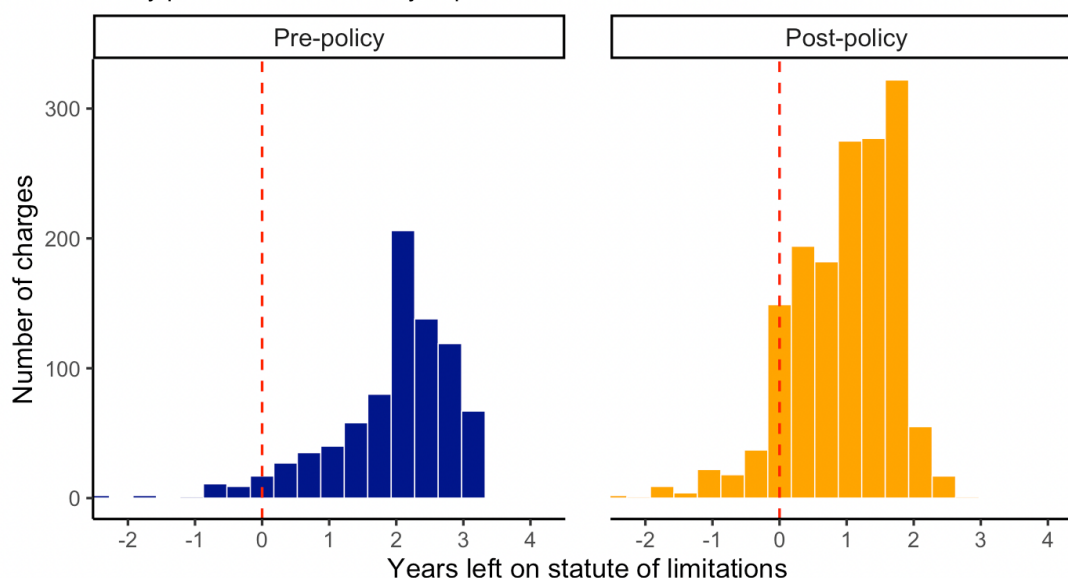
Interpretation	There is a statistically significant association between offense group and case pathway.
-----------------------	--

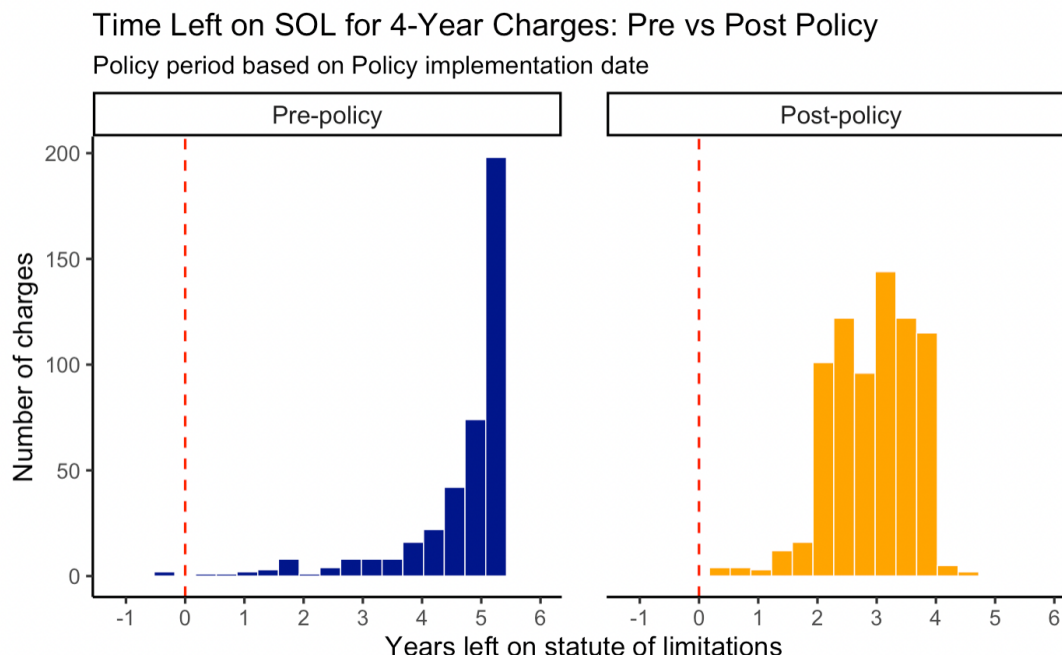
To formally test whether these differences in offense group distribution are meaningful, a Pearson's Chi-square test was conducted. This test evaluates whether the two variables (offense group and case pathway) are independent of each other. The results show a significant relationship between offense group and case pathway ($p < 0.001$), meaning that the offense group and policy groups are not independent, concluding that the types of offense are not similar between the charges DA took and the charges that State Court transferred to the DA's office. In other words, certain offense groups are more likely to be taken directly by the DA, while others are more likely to be transferred.

Remaining time for State Court charges by 2 and 4 year SOL charges

Time Left on SOL for 2-Year Charges: Pre vs Post Policy

Policy period based on Policy implementation date

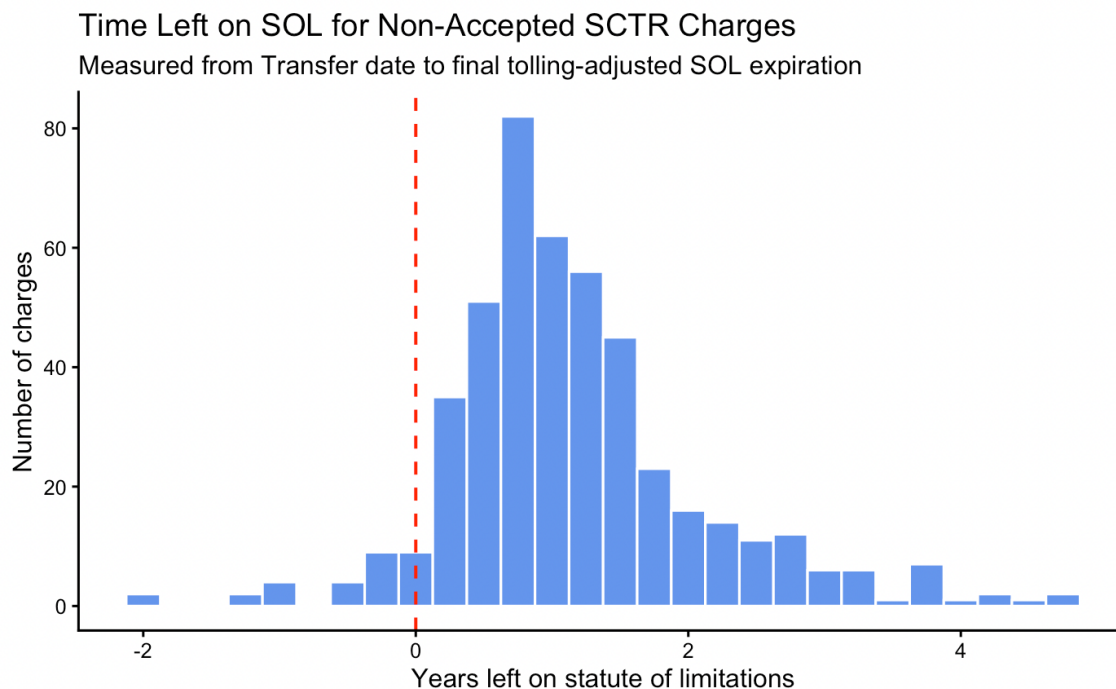




These histograms show the distribution of time remaining on the statute of limitations (SOL) for charges using the actual, offense-based SOL lengths, with the top graph focusing on 2-year offenses and the bottom graph on 4-year offenses. This differs from the main analysis, where all State Court charges were standardized and assumed into a 2-year SOL. Using the actual SOL lengths that matches the offense of each charge provides a more precise view of legal timelines, but the overall pattern remains similar. Also, instead of solely looking at charges post policy, these graphs provide the differences in remaining time on the SOL between policy periods.

Across both graphs, pre-policy charges tend to cluster at higher amounts of time remaining, while post-policy charges show a wider spread and include more observations closer to zero. The dashed red line marks the point of SOL expiration. Compared to pre-policy, the post-policy distributions show a greater concentration of charges with lower remaining SOL and more variability across the range of values. These differences are statistically significant for both 2-year and 4-year offenses (Wilcoxon rank-sum tests, $W = 217,668$ and $W = 23,480$, respectively, both $p < 0.001$).

Remaining time on SOL for SCTR charges not accepted



SCTR charges that were not accepted still has time left on the SOL, but are still relatively shorter (most are less than or around a year).

5. Pre Charging Unit

Linear Regression for Days for Evidence Upload per Era

```
lm(days_to_evidence ~ event * period, data = evidence_period)
```

Variable	Estimate	Std. Error
Main Effects		
Intercept	1.7284	0.0160 ***
Body Camera Video	0.5054	0.0211 ***
Criminal History	-0.3109	0.0182 ***
Drivers License Record / Photograph	-0.4881	0.0277 ***
PCU Investigation	-0.2798	0.0199 ***
Photographs	0.5728	0.0276 ***
Police Report	0.5239	0.0184 ***
Probable Cause - Arrest Warrant	-1.9747	0.0235 ***
Statements	0.1726	0.0311 ***
Warrant - Magistrate Court/Citations	-0.4693	0.0182 ***
Interaction Effects (x PCU 2)		
Period: PCU 2 (2022-2025)	0.7278	0.0206 ***

All the evidence types have asterisks meaning that the variables in the model are statistically significant and not due to random chance. The evidence types with negative estimates such as criminal history, indicate faster digital upload time meaning the expansion of the PCU decreased upload time. The positive numbers for evidence types such as photographs indicate a longer upload time. Which remains fairly consistent with the findings in image 19.

Metric	Value
Residual Standard Error (RSE)	2.568
Multiple R-squared	0.09682
F-statistic	4593
Model p-value	< 2.2e-16

The p-value of the model is below .05 meaning it is statistically significant. Paired with the high F-statistic, we can conclude that the model is statistically significant overall. The Multiple R-squared statistic means that the model is explaining about 10 percent of what is driving evidence upload duration; however, the other 90% is noise the model can't see, for example, the unit's workload at any given time or other nuances. While the model is significant,

the explanatory power is low meaning that while there is an impact on the implementation of the PCU and its expansion on upload time, the unit is not the only force explaining the change.

Finally, the residual standard error(RSE) is approximately 2.6, meaning the predictions vary by about 2.6 days from the actual values.

Welch Two-Sample t-test for Annual PCU Collection Per Era

Welch Two Sample t-test Results					
Comparison	Mean_Group1	Mean_Group2	t_statistic	df	p_value
pre_pcu vs pcu1	0.0554	0.9646	-441.5800	15485	< 2.2e-16
pcu1 vs pcu2	0.9646	0.9628	0.6384	16688	0.5233
pre_pcu vs pcu2	0.0554	0.9628	-390.6600	10988	< 2.2e-16

A two-sample t-test determines whether the difference between two groups is truly different or a result of random chance. Within this context, the t-test answers the question of whether the difference in annual evidence logged between each PCU era is statistically significant. Within this context, statistical significance means that there is a genuine difference between the amount of digitally logged evidence. With this in mind, the t-test is going to consider how big the differences are between the two groups and the natural variation that exists within both groups. The mean, or percent values, indicate the proportion of cases that had digitally logged evidence in each era.

The P-value then tells us the odds of the difference being by chance. If the P-value is below 0.05, that means that there's less than a 5% chance the difference is random, making it statistically significant, meaning we can say the difference between groups is real.

I first begin by comparing the pre-PCU group, which contains the years 2016-2019, and PCU 1, which contains the years 2019-2022, to test whether the difference in volume between the annual digital logged evidence for these two groups can be attributed to a genuine difference or random change.

The results show that the difference between the two groups is statistically significant. The percent of evidence logged jumped from approximately 5.5% to 96.5%. The P value is less than .05 meaning that the difference between groups is statistically significant. The test results indicate that the initial implementation of the Pre-charging units investigative arm created a dramatic shift in digitally logged evidence.

Another test was run to observe the difference between the PCU1(2019-2022) and PCU2 era (2022-current). The evidence logging stayed virtually the same between 96.5% vs 96.3% additionally the p-value was above .05 meaning the difference in logged evidence between the two eras is not significant.

For consistency, I ran the t-test to observe differences between the Pre-PCU and PCU2, and the findings remained consistent with the first t-test between Pre-PCU and PCU21. There is a statistical difference between PCU2 and the Pre-PCU era, seeing that there was a jump between the means, and the p-value is statistically significant.

6. Diversion

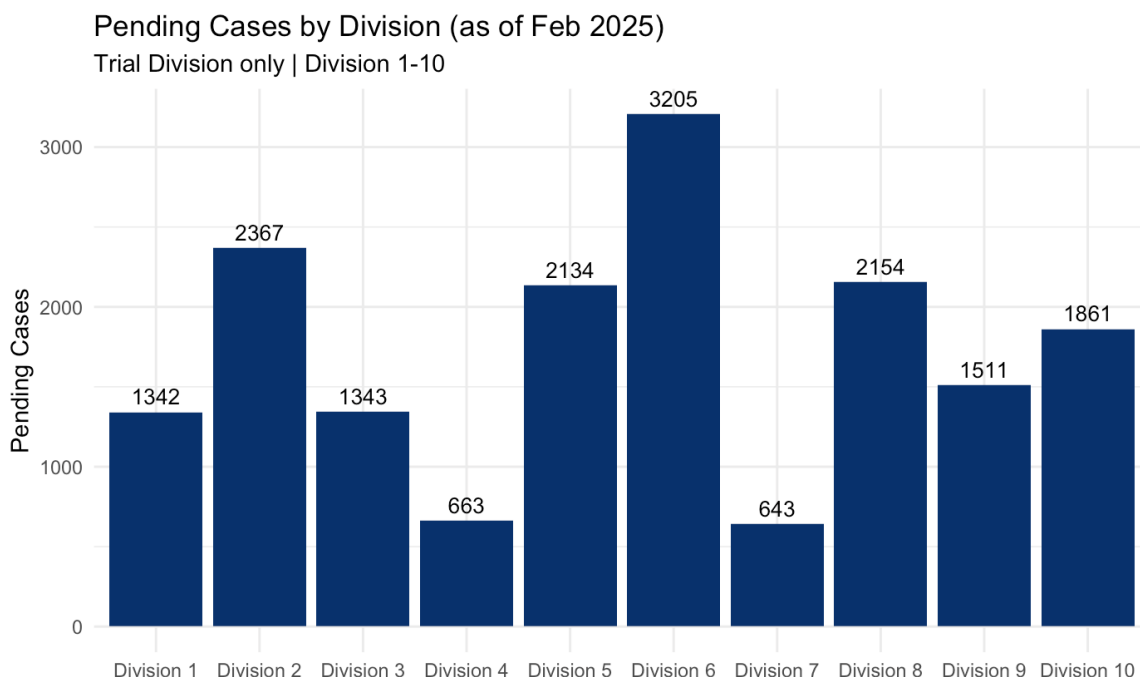
Welch Two Sample t-test for duration of cases with or without diversion:

Comparison	Mean (group 1)	Mean (group 2)	T statistic	df	P value
Diversion, charged vs Non-Diversion, charged	471.02	364.00	3.13	615.7	0.002

A two-sample t-test was conducted between charged cases that were approved for diversion and those that could qualify but didn't engage in diversion. Examining the statistical significance of the differences between groups, a t-test would reveal whether the difference observed between such two groups were due to chance or true difference. A p-value lower than significance level 0.05 suggests that there is indeed a statistically significant difference in the distribution of the two groups we're interested: charged cases enrolled in diversion and those without diversion.

The mean values here represent the average duration of cases from arrest to filing within each group. With a p-value as low as 0.002, we would conclude that there exists significant differences between cases when it comes to diversion. Instead of observing such differences out of chance, it is reasonable to hypothesize potential effects of diversion on longer case duration.

7. Pending Cases



Pending cases by division

From the graph of Pending Cases by Division burden of pending felony cases is not evenly distributed across the Trial Division. As of February 2025, some divisions carry substantially heavier caseloads than others. For example, Division 6 has the highest number of pending cases (over 3,200), while Divisions 4 and 7 each have fewer than 700 cases. Several other divisions, such as Divisions 2, 5, and 8, also have notably high caseloads exceeding 2,000 cases. This wide variation suggests that the overall backlog is not only large but also unevenly allocated, indicating potential imbalances in staffing, case assignment, or case complexity across divisions.

=== Chi-square Goodness-of-Fit Test ===

Tests whether pending cases are evenly distributed across Divisions

X-squared: 3256.858

df: 9

p-value: 0

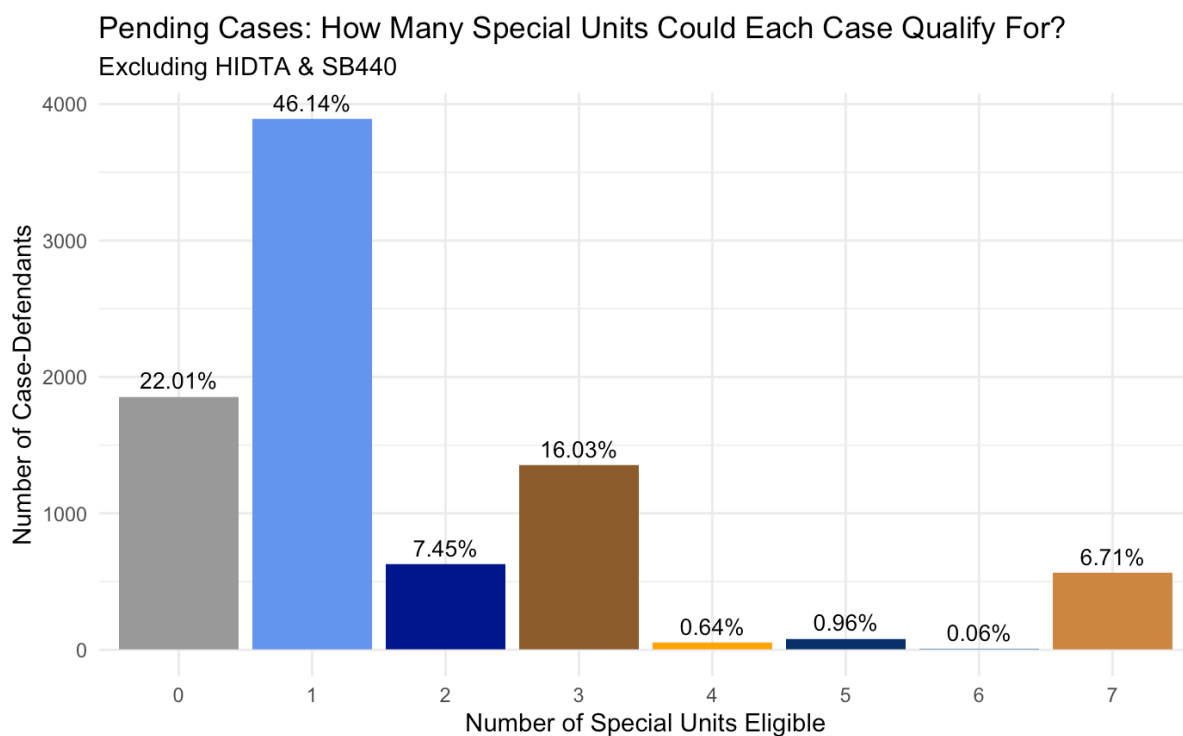
Result: Pending caseload is significantly different across Divisions ($p < 0.05$)

=== Division-Level Breakdown ===

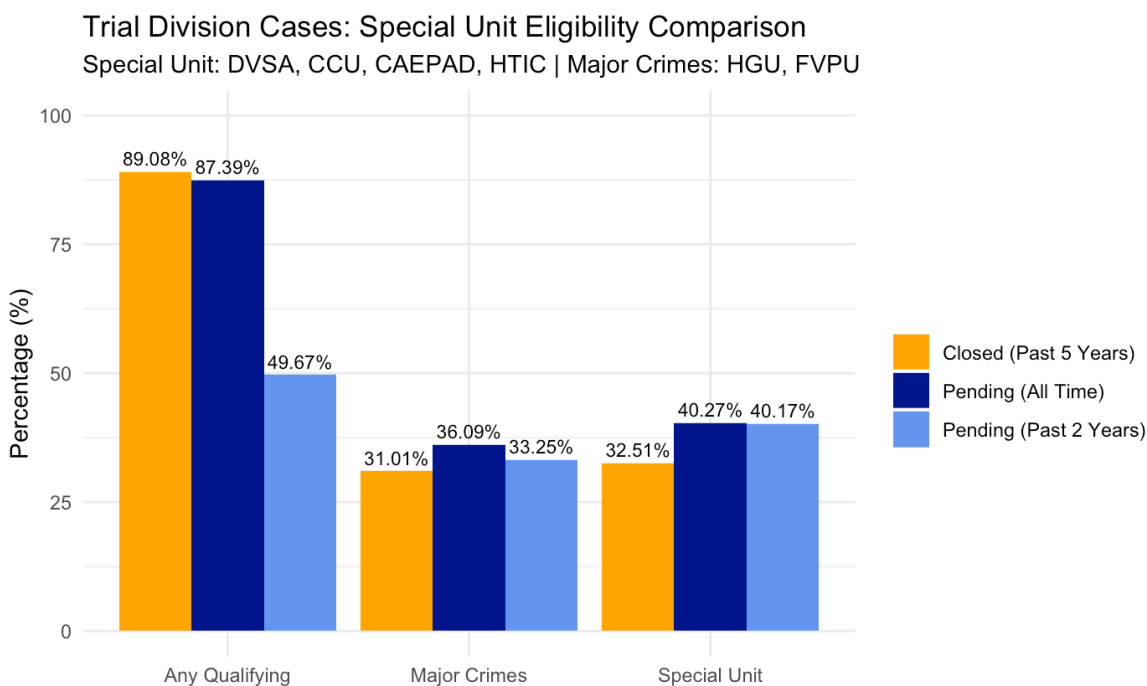
A tibble: 10 × 4

	Division	pending_count	expected	pct_diff
	<chr>	<int>	<dbl>	<dbl>
1	Division 1	1342	1722	-22.1
2	Division 10	1861	1722	8.1
3	Division 2	2367	1722	37.5
4	Division 3	1343	1722	-22
5	Division 4	663	1722	-61.5
6	Division 5	2134	1722	23.9
7	Division 6	3205	1722	86.1
8	Division 7	643	1722	-62.7
9	Division 8	2154	1722	25.1
10	Division 9	1511	1722	-12.3

A chi-square goodness-of-fit test was performed to determine whether pending felony cases are evenly distributed across the ten Trial Division courtrooms. The test ($X^2 = 3,256.86$, $df = 9$, $p < 0.001$) rejected the null hypothesis of equal distribution, confirming that pending caseloads differ significantly across Divisions. Division 6 carries the heaviest load at 3,205 cases (86.1% above the expected average of 1,722), while Division 7 carries the lightest at 643 cases (62.7% below average). These differences cannot be explained by random variation alone, though factors such as case complexity, offense type, and judge scheduling practices likely contribute to the uneven distribution.



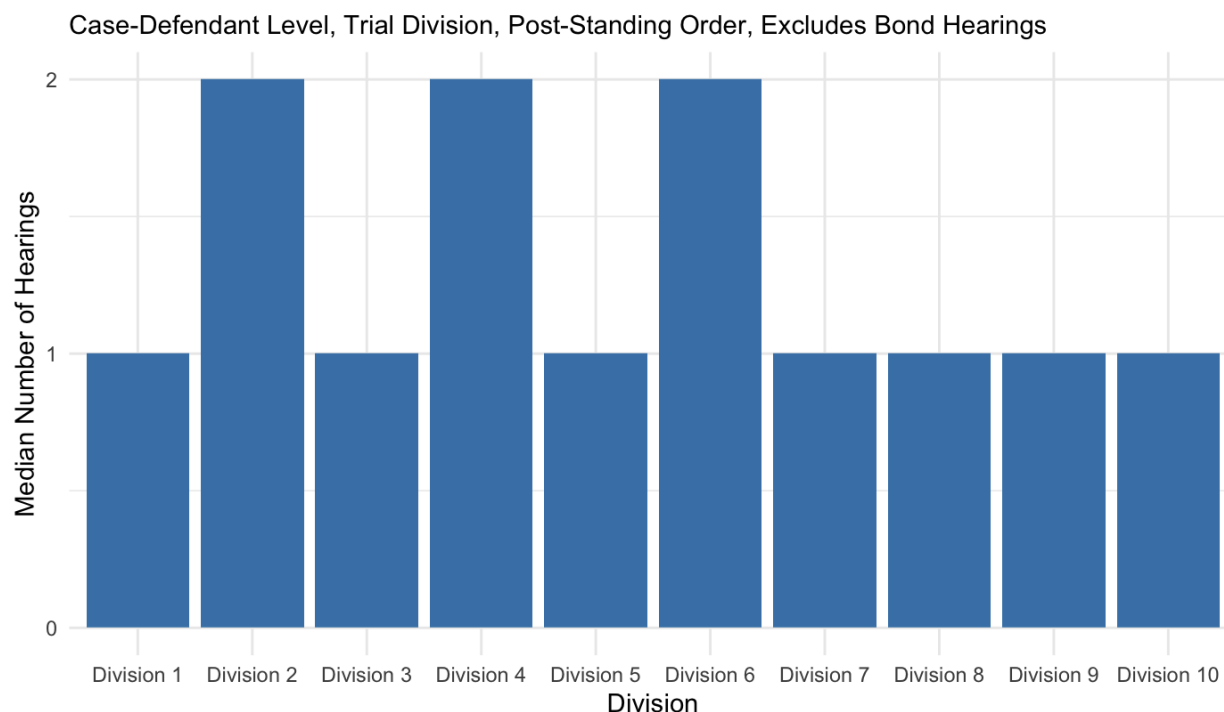
The distribution of multi-unit eligibility reveals the extent of overlap across special units. Only 22% of pending case-defendants do not qualify for any special unit. The largest group, 46.14%, qualifies for exactly one unit, representing straightforward redistribution candidates with a clear destination. Another 16.03% qualify for three units, and 7.45% qualify for two, indicating that a substantial number of cases sit at the intersection of multiple specializations. A notable 6.71% qualify for all seven units, suggesting a subset of cases with offense profiles that touch nearly every special unit category.



The three comparison groups tell a consistent story. Across all pending cases, cases closed between 2020 and 2025, and cases received in the past two years, the eligibility rates hold steady. Roughly 87 to 89 percent of case-defendants qualify for at least one special unit. The Special Unit category (DVSA, CCU, CAEPAD, HTIC) accounts for 32 to 40 percent, while Major Crimes (HGU, FVPU) accounts for 31 to 36 percent. The “Pending (Past 2 Years)” group is particularly telling because it strips out the old COVID backlog and represents a typical incoming caseload. Even in this narrower window, about half of case-defendants qualify for redistribution. The takeaway is clear: the high eligibility rate is not an artifact of accumulated old cases or pandemic-era disruption. It reflects the fundamental composition of cases flowing into the Trial Division. This pattern has persisted over time and will continue unless the case routing process is adjusted.

8. Scheduling

Median Hearings Among Closed CR Case-Defendants by Division (August 2022-December 2025)



As this figure demonstrates, it typically takes 1 or 2 hearings across Divisions before case-defendants are closed.

ANOVA Results for Case-Defendant Closure Time by Division

Term	Df	Sum of Squares	Mean Square	F Statistic	p-value
as.factor(division)	9	54139848	6015538.68	126.8161	<0.001
Residuals	3043	144345069	47435.12	NA	NA

An Analysis of Variance (ANOVA) is a way to answer this question: “Do these groups actually differ from each other, or are the differences I see just random?” This specific ANOVA compares different Divisions and finds that there is a statistically significant difference in how long it takes them to close a case-defendant.

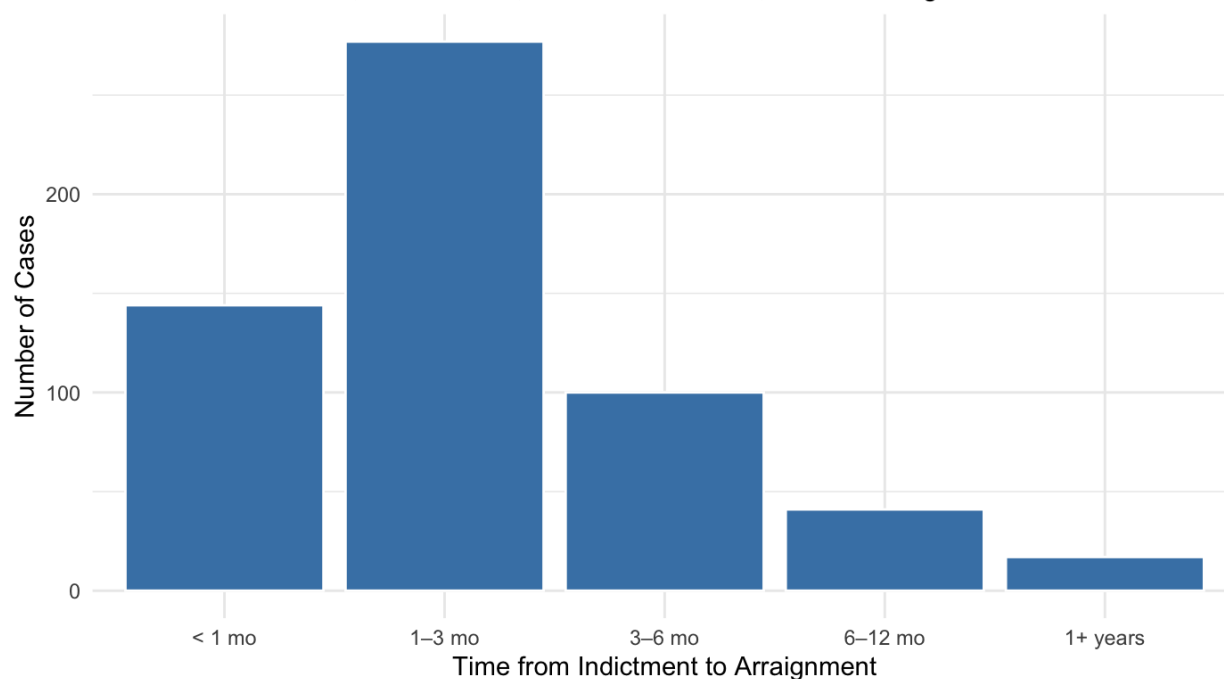
Post-Hoc Testing for Case-Defendant Closure Time by Division

Comparison	Difference	Lower CI	Upper CI	p-value
Division 4-Division 1	-194.290	-268.249	-120.331	<0.001
Division 4-Division 2	-173.725	-210.216	-137.234	<0.001
Division 6-Division 2	119.551	75.407	163.695	<0.001
Division 8-Division 2	161.194	113.733	208.655	<0.001
Division 4-Division 3	-241.248	-324.682	-157.814	<0.001
Division 5-Division 4	197.072	131.598	262.546	<0.001
Division 6-Division 4	293.276	256.785	329.767	<0.001
Division 8-Division 4	334.919	294.479	375.359	<0.001
Division 9-Division 8	-288.620	-410.535	-166.704	<0.001
Division 9-Division 6	-246.977	-367.640	-126.314	<0.001
Division 8-Division 5	137.847	65.682	210.012	<0.001
Division 10-Division 8	-283.690	-434.987	-132.392	<0.001
Division 8-Division 7	232.059	103.155	360.963	<0.001
Division 8-Division 1	140.629	60.686	220.572	<0.001
Division 10-Division 6	-242.047	-392.337	-91.757	<0.001
Division 7-Division 6	-190.416	-318.137	-62.696	<0.001
Division 6-Division 5	96.204	26.176	166.232	<0.001
Division 9-Division 3	-194.949	-337.037	-52.860	<0.001
Division 6-Division 1	98.986	20.967	177.006	0.002
Division 9-Division 5	-150.773	-283.116	-18.429	0.012
Division 10-Division 3	-190.019	-357.997	-22.040	0.013
Division 9-Division 1	-147.990	-284.731	-11.250	0.022
Division 9-Division 2	-127.426	-248.089	-6.763	0.029
Division 8-Division 3	93.671	4.889	182.452	0.029

Unfortunately, the ANOVA test alone does not tell us *which* groups are statistically significantly different from each other. Post-hoc testing solves this issue and is what this table demonstrates; in other words, these are the 24 division pairs that contain statistically significant differences in their case-defendant closure times.

Distribution of Indictment to Arraignment Duration (August 2022-December 2025)

Case-Defendant Level, Trial Division, No Bench Warrants, Post-Standing Order



As this figure demonstrates, most case-defendants take 1 to 3 months to proceed from indictment to arraignment. There are some outliers, however; some case-defendants require 1 year or more.

ANOVA Results for Indictment to Arraignment Duration by Division

Term	Df	Sum of Squares	Mean Square	F Statistic	p-value
as.factor(division)	9	789534	87725.99	4.17	<0.001
Residuals	569	11971061	21038.77	NA	NA

An Analysis of Variance (ANOVA) is a way to answer this question: “Do these groups actually differ from each other, or are the differences I see just random?” This specific ANOVA compares different Divisions and finds that there is a statistically significant difference in how long it takes them to proceed from indictment to arraignment.

Post-Hoc Testing for Indictment to Arraignment Duration by Division

Comparison	Difference	Lower CI	Upper CI	p-value
Division 6-Division 4	86.893	34.201	139.586	<0.001
Division 6-Division 2	79.453	17.994	140.913	0.002

Unfortunately, the ANOVA test alone does not tell us *which* groups are statistically significantly different from each other. Post-hoc testing solves this issue and is what this table demonstrates; in other words, these are the 2 division pairs that contain statistically significant differences in their indictment to arraignment times.

ANOVA Results for Arraignment to Subsequent Hearing Duration by Division

Term	Df	Sum of Squares	Mean Square	F Statistic	p-value
as.factor(division)	8	1402743	175342.9	9.412	<0.001
Residuals	757	14102152	18629.0	NA	NA

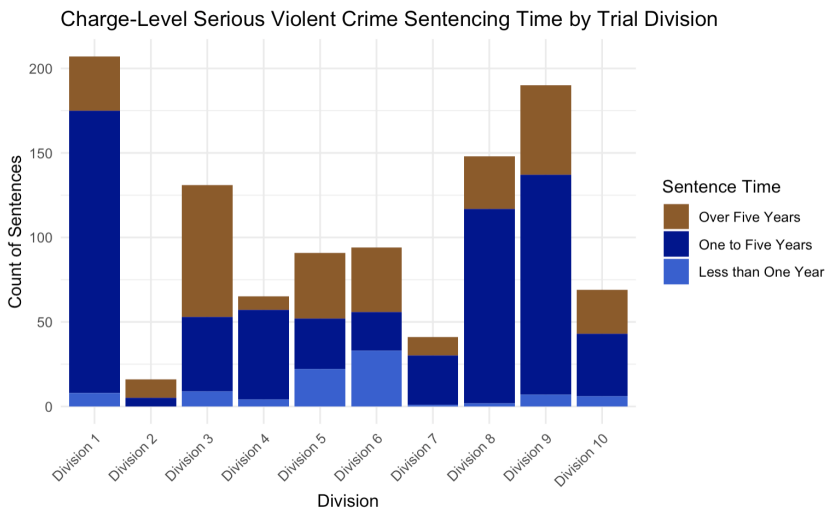
An Analysis of Variance (ANOVA) is a way to answer this question: “Do these groups actually differ from each other, or are the differences I see just random?” This specific ANOVA compares different Divisions and finds that there is a statistically significant difference in how long it takes them to proceed from arraignment to the subsequent hearing.

Post-Hoc Testing for Arraignment to Subsequent Hearing Duration by Division

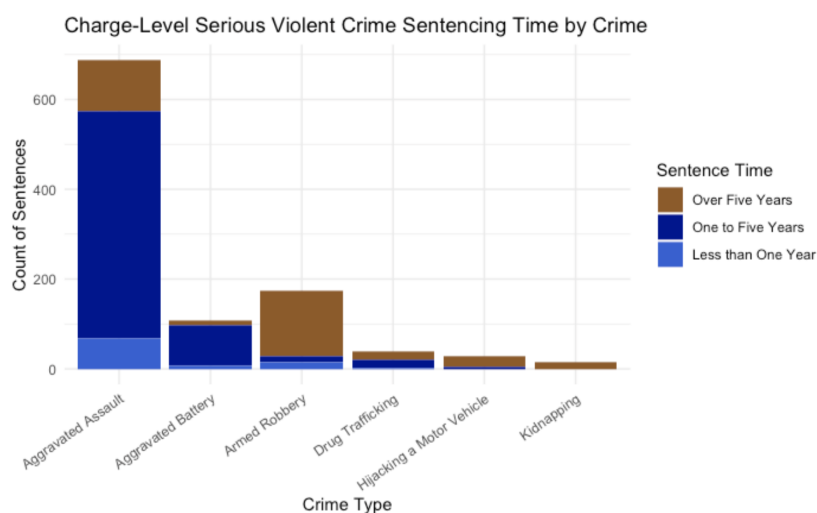
Comparison	Difference	Lower CI	Upper CI	p-value
Division 4-Division 2	-90.325	-130.50	-50.150	<0.001
Division 6-Division 4	89.391	44.86	133.922	<0.001

Unfortunately, the ANOVA test alone does not tell us *which* groups are statistically significantly different from each other. Post-hoc testing solves this issue and is what this table demonstrates; in other words, these are the 2 division pairs that contain statistically significant differences in their arraignment to subsequent hearing times.

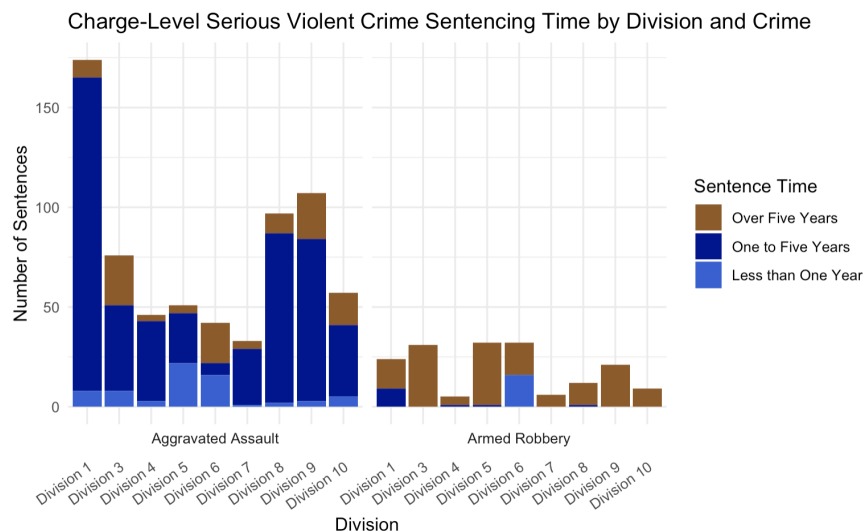
9. Outcomes



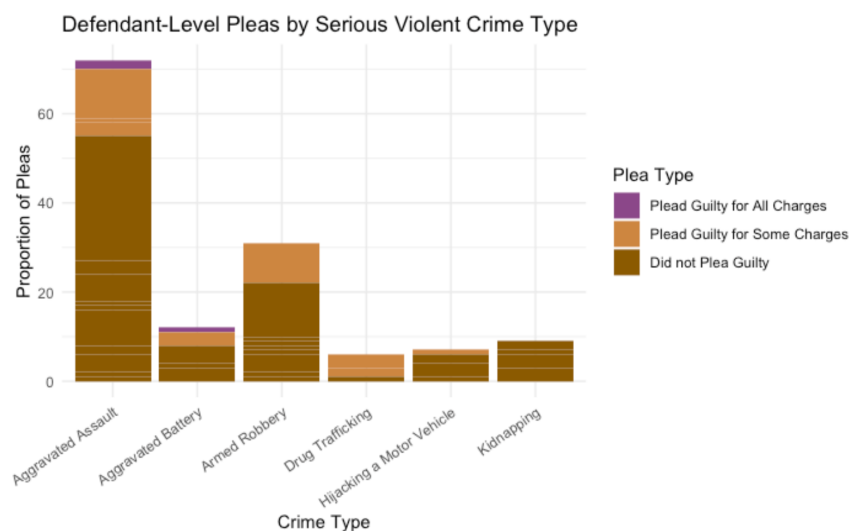
Charge-Level Serious Violent Crime Sentencing Time by Trial Division limits the data to defendants with SVCs sentenced to confinement and shows the information for all of the SVC charges per defendant. This shows that most people are sentenced to between one to five years.



Charge-Level Serious Violent Crime Sentencing Time by Crime limits data to SVC charges sentenced to confinement. It looks at the sentencing time of a single charge individually. Thus, it may not properly represent a case with sentencing time broken up into several different charges. It shows the number of cases in each SVC category and the typical sentencing time for each crime.



Serious Violent Crime's Sentencing Time By Division and Crime only looks among the SVC charges of those imprisoned. This visualization only looks at SVCs with over 5 instances per listed division. Since Division 2 was a chief judge, it did not have enough data for any of the categories and was excluded. It shows that the number of each SVC case varies substantially by division, but most divisions generally give the same amount of confinement time, likely in line with sentencing standards.



Defendant-Level Pleas by Serious Violent Crime Type only looks at charges that went to trial. If a defendant committed multiple SVCs, then they are in here multiple times. It shows that the majority of people didn't plead guilty for any charges.